

Bosnia and Herzegovina 2014 Floods

After Action Review of UNDP's Response

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List of Acronyms

AAR	After Action Review
APC	Assets and Procurement Committee
BiH	Bosnia and Herzegovina
BCPR	Bureau for Crisis Prevention and Response
BERA	Bureau for External relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau for Management Support
BPPS	Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund
CfW	Cash for Work
CO	Country Office
CRP	Crisis Response Package
CRT	Crisis Response Team
CRU	Crisis Response Unit
CSOPs	Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
DfID	Department for International Development
DRM	Disaster Risk Management
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
ECHO	EU Humanitarian Aid and Civil Protection department
EoI	Expression of Interest
EU	European Union
EUR	Euro
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
FBiH	Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
FRP	Floods Recovery Programme
FTPs	Fast Track Procedures
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
HQ	Headquarters
IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee
ICFCM	International Community Flood Coordination Meetings
IOM	International Organization for Migration
LoA	Letter of Agreement
LTA	Long-Term Agreement
OCHA	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Action
PDNA	Post-Disaster Needs Assessment
PSO	Procurement Support Office
RC	Resident Coordinator
RNA	Recovery Needs Assessment
RR	Resident Representative
RS	Republika Srpska
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
UN	United Nations
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNFPA	United Nations Population Fund
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
USD	United States Dollars
WFP	World Food Programme

Executive Summary

Introduction

UNDP conducted an After Action Review (AAR) of the response to floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH) in 2014. The floods caused extensive damage and UNDP BiH Country Office (CO) rapidly designed and implemented immediate response and early recovery projects, followed by comprehensive recovery programmes. The organization mobilized ample resources: 1.2 million USD in CERF grants, and more than 80¹ million USD for recovery. It has been a successful example of a well-managed and effective operation, implementing a remarkable and creative programme.

The AAR analyzes the response, documents enabling factors and good practices, and what can be learned to improve UNDP's future performance. It will inform the revision of the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for immediate crisis response and the finalization of the Crisis Response Packages (CRPs).

Analysis of the floods response

A few days before the floods hit in May 2014, experienced senior management recognized the early warning signs of an impending crisis and took immediate preparedness and early actions: it appointed the Crisis Response Team (CRT), set-up coordination and information management systems, activated crisis response corporate tools like TRAC funds and Fast Track Procedures, engaged authorities and UN regional offices. The emergency was categorized as L2 but managed internally by UNDP as an L1, given the critical capacities available within the CO.

Early action positioned strongly the UN as a reliable and effective actor, it increased the confidence of the state and entities on UN's ability to coordinate the response, a task it was eventually assigned. Preparedness and early actions were successful and paid off; at the same time, the weakness of the national coordination and response capacity, unable to lead the response, opened up the opportunity for the UN.

The RC established the International Community Flood Coordination Meetings (ICFCM), attended by all response actors, including donors. UNDP became the information and coordination hub and the clearinghouse for quality information on needs, gaps, resources and response. The leadership role assumed by UNDP in coordination and information management gave further visibility to the quality and reliability of its response. Preparedness and rapid early action, effectiveness in coordination and information management, and the initial programmatic interventions positioned UNDP strategically at the centre of the response. This reinforced donors' confidence and was instrumental in securing the large funds UNDP later received for recovery programmes.

At the end of May, UNDP received USD 1.2 million in CERF funds for debris management and mine action; in June, it opened three field offices to support the response and recovery. Field presence was a key element of UNDP's performance. The majority of other agencies did not have field presence and this constituted a distinct advantage for the organization.

Initial funds in sufficient amounts are fundamental for the success of the response and for additional resource mobilization. Seed funds give the organization the resources to start a response early on, positioning it in the humanitarian landscape (where it might have not been strong or even present). They boost its credibility vis-à-vis donors, as the organization

¹ This figure includes resilience projects implemented under the recovery umbrella.

is able to match funds with its own resources; they might provide opportunities or leverage to negotiate for joint interventions with other humanitarian actors, multiplying the results.

UNDP's share of the CERF funds for BiH represents around 60% of the total allocation, an exceptional allocation compared to UNDP's usual rates. The successful mobilization of humanitarian funds originates in:

- UNDP's demonstrated ability to deliver (thanks to the immediate performance guaranteed by initial TRAC funds, field presence, coordination and information management role);
- The time-critical and/or life-saving character of intended actions;
- A limited presence and capacity of traditional humanitarian agencies;
- Assessed needs in line with UNDP's expertise and added value.

In June, the EU led the Recovery Needs Assessment (RNA): damages and losses amounted to nearly 15% of the country GDP; the hardest hit economic sectors were agriculture, transport and productive activities. The quality of the RNA was reduced by the very short timeframe available, the strong political pressures that required a revision of the damages and losses estimations, the limited integration of a proper gender perspective.

Recovery programmes built upon response activities and were based on the RNA and on UNDP's assessments. The EU Floods Recovery Programme (EU FRP) was a 43.53 million EUR programme, funded mainly by the EU (42.25 million EUR), with a EUR 1.28 million UNDP contribution. It had three specific objectives: emergency housing rehabilitation; rehabilitation and restoration of public services and facilities and communal infrastructure; and livelihoods support. The successful mobilization of recovery funds derived from:

- The effective delivery on humanitarian funds, showing UNDP's capacity and reliability;
- A rapid, efficient reporting on funds received, increasing donor's trust on the organization's absorption capacity to manage further resources;
- An evidence-based recovery programme design;
- The lack of a National Recovery Plan, which directed funds to UNDP instead of national programmes.

The UN Floods Recovery Programme (UN FRP) was a USD 22 million framework programme supported by many bilateral donors (10 bilateral donors in total, including Norway, Japan, DFID, USAID and ECHO, as well as over 38 recovery partners, among others the Government of BiH represented by different institutions²). The framework programme covered all needs identified, but it did include separate project proposals; these were developed only once a donor was interested in either providing non-earmarked assistance, or in funding a particular segment of the programme. The factors that contributed to the UN FRP resource mobilization were:

- The development of an evidence-based, comprehensive framework programme by

² According to UNDP internal reports, bilateral donors include: the European Commission (ECHO), the Governments of BiH, Japan, Norway, Romania, Slovak Republic, United Kingdom (DFID), and USA (USAID), as well as UNDP/BCPR and UNOCHA/CERF; while recovery partners include: Brcko District, City of Bijeljina, City of Doboj, City of Prijedor, City of Tuzla, City of Zenica, Federal Fund for Support to the Affected Areas by Natural Disasters, Federal Ministry of Physical Planning, Hospital "Sveti Apostol Luka" Doboj, Ministry of Agriculture, Water Management and Forestry of Posavina Canton, Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports of Zenica-Doboj Canton, Ministry of Finance, Republika Srpska, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Municipalities of Doboj Jug, Domaljevac-Samac, Donji Zabar, Gorazde, Gracanica, Gradacac, Kalesija, Kljuc, Lopare, Maglaj, Milici, Modrica, Odzak, Olovo, Samac, Sanski Most, Srebrenik, Teslic, Travnik, Velika Kladusa, Vogosca, Zepce, Zvornik, Posavina Canton and the Solidarity Fund for the RS Recovery.

June 2014, linking relief, recovery and the transition back to development and resilience;

- The flexibility it gave donors to fund parts of the programmes in which they were interested;
- The flexibility to include small scale or self contained projects in parallel with broader activities;
- The joint implementation with other UN agencies, which required channelling of the funds through UNDP for administrative reasons;
- The magnet effect for smaller donors.

The CO strived for a seamless transition between response, early recovery and recovery activities. As it prepared the response, it kept early recovery and recovery in mind. Response and recovery projects consistently targeted the most vulnerable groups, such as returnees, beneficiaries of social welfare and social care centres, unemployed, single parents and Roma people. Programmatic linkages between existing activities, response, recovery, DRR and resilience strengthening increase programme quality. All recovery projects benefitted from a risk assessment, deemed as a critical prerequisite for sustainable recovery, indicating where not to invest because of the high risk of further flooding or landslides. The CO took several measures to strengthen accountability, especially to the affected population.

Programme quality improves by ensuring the integration of gender perspective in needs assessments, programme design and programme implementation; although not completely lacking, in BiH it was insufficient, as the same CO recognized in its lessons learned exercise on gender approach in the floods response.

The CO did not request operational support to HQ or RH in form of deployments, as in-house capacity was sufficient. Corporate support instead included Fast Track Procedures, rapid approval of procurement contracts above the FTP thresholds, access to the global LTAs with the UN Depots. The Operations team introduced novel practices, like the publication of an Expression of Interest prior to tenders, to conduct a market analysis and to speed up procedures once funds became available for expenditure. The right early actions or preparedness actions by Operations (such as the market analysis and EoI described above) can increase and accelerate the delivery capacity of the CO, contributing to its performance.

Successes and challenges identified

Successes of the response and enabling factors

Leadership: Experienced senior management provided leadership in the crisis response and recovery, by initiating preparedness and early response actions, using corporate tools available for response and recovery, rapidly taking critical decisions that facilitated the response, anticipating potential difficulties and taking required measures to counter their impact. It also supported national staff in running the response and endorsed unusual but innovative approaches that proved to be successful.

Early action: The CO, under the guidance of the Resident Coordinator (RC), was very reactive and fast in taking early actions that facilitated the response. Rapidity and decisiveness allowed quick resolution of emerging issues or avoided them altogether and expedited the response and recovery in multiple ways.

Knowledge and use of corporate support and corporate tools for crisis response: Both management and staff, including former SURGE deployees, knew and activated crisis response procedures, and were aware of how to best implement them.

CO capacity and field presence: The CO had a capable, experienced team, including several staff members as SURGE Advisors (both in Programme and Operations). The CO had a solid network and field presence, which was expanded with the opening of three more field offices, and was a key element of UNDP's performance. The majority of other agencies did not have field presence and this constituted a distinct advantage for the organization.

National response: The national response (as opposed to and international humanitarian surge) was a strength. Key strategic decisions were taken immediately and on the ground, the committed team of the CO leveraged its knowledge of the context and the language, the networks and relations established in pre-floods activities, managed activities through all phases, transitioning from crisis response and early recovery to recovery and now back to normal programmes, DRR and resilience building.

Nature of programmes and UNDP's mandate: Assessed needs matched UNDP's experience and signature products³ like debris removal, cash for work, emergency employment, livelihoods restoration (more frequently, emergency immediate needs are food, WASH, health, shelter). The experience and technical knowledge of the sectors that constituted the bulk of immediate response and recovery facilitated quality and creative programme design and implementation. UNDP's recovery mandate, and previous work in governance, local development, livelihoods, DRR, allowed seamless phasing-in and phasing-out of programmatic interventions.

Relation with authorities at national and local level: UNDP had a positive relation with government counterparts, at state and entity level, despite the complex governance structure of the country. Relations were also very solid with local authorities and especially municipalities thanks to pre-existing programmes. This facilitated needs assessments and implementation of activities.

Relations with donors and resource mobilization: The positive and longstanding relation with donors allowed rapid consultations for repurposing of funds, which were critical for the initial response, together with TRAC and CERF funds; donors trusted UNDP's recommendations for the immediate response, and for recovery later on. The successful resource mobilization of humanitarian funds, made possible by the access to seed funds to kick-start the response, in turn contributed greatly to the extremely successful mobilization of recovery funds.

Critical Information and coordination role played by UNDP: The leadership role assumed by UNDP in coordination and information management gave visibility to its work and to the quality of its response. Its effectiveness in coordination and information management positioned UNDP strategically at the centre of the response, reinforced the donors' confidence in the organisation and was ultimately instrumental in securing the large funding it later received for recovery programmes.

Opportunities created by the context: Some favourable circumstances have partially contributed to the CO achievements. These include the lack of national capacities to coordinate and implement the response, which provided the space for UNDP to take a leading role; the limited presence of traditional humanitarian actors, that reduced the competition for funding; the status of BiH as a pre-accession country, which influenced the political opportunity of a large external intervention, favouring instead a BiH-based response.

³ UNDP "Signature Products" have now evolved into "Crisis Response Packages" (CRPs) with additional elements that complement the guidance notes with practical programme, operations, communications, resource mobilization and deployable capacity tools.

Challenges and gaps

Gender equality programming: The integration of gender equality in the response and recovery activities could have been stronger: it was insufficient or insufficiently integrated in needs assessments⁴, including the RNA; UNDP did not conduct a proper gender analysis prior to programme design, and the recovery programmes do not present a comprehensive gender equality approach. UNDP has recognized this gap and conducted a “lessons learned” exercise on the integration of gender equality in its programming, identifying specific areas for improvement in current and future programming.

CO preparedness: The CO had not *intentionally* prepared to respond nor taken substantial preparedness measures; coincidentally, it was well positioned to do it and implemented a successful response, thanks to the multiple enabling factors earlier identified; there was not, however, a structural commitment to preparedness.

Real-time evaluation: During the response, the CO did not conduct real-time assessments/evaluations on the quality of the response, losing the chance of identifying and correcting potential overlooks and pitfalls.

UNDP internal systems: The nature of the programme in BiH required expensive procurement, which often surpassed the CO authority even with the increased threshold of the FTPs. The process was burdensome and could benefit from simplification for emergency contexts (beyond and in addition to existing FTPs).

RNA: The quality of the RNA was reduced by the very short timeframe available, the strong political pressures that required a revision of the damages and losses estimations, the limited integration of a proper gender perspective.

Limited national capacities: National authorities were not able to manage efficiently the coordination of the response; there had been limited previous work with the state on preparedness and disaster risk management. Initially a challenge, it became an opportunity for UNDP to take a leading role.

Local ownership: Local ownership of the response sometimes was limited, when political consideration overshadowed the need to assist the population. The CO reports that accountability to affected populations by local authorities remained elusive, despite the significant efforts deployed by the organization.

Reduced capacity of some UN agencies: Some UN agencies had limited capacity to respond and did not always step up as required and as expected, leaving gaps to be covered. Nevertheless, their limited presence became an opportunity for UNDP, as it reduced the competition for humanitarian funds.

Conclusions and recommendations

The BiH CO response and recovery to 2014 floods was very good. The BiH CO used effectively internal and corporate resources to deliver a rapid and efficient response. Creative, evidence-based recovery activities were consistent with crisis response and provided continuity until the transition back to the development pathway; resource mobilization was extremely successful. Corporate mechanisms facilitated the operational side of response and recovery. Operation’s performance was effective and used available tools smartly to expedite delivery.

⁴ In the RNA gender equality is not mainstreamed in the document but included in a separate chapter; UN Women has produced a stand-alone report titled “Gender Equality in Post-Disaster Needs Assessment in Bosnia-Herzegovina”.

The following recommendations aim at improving some aspects of the CO performance, while recommendations for UNDP reach beyond BiH and aim at improving the corporate capacity to prepare for and respond to crises.

Recommendations for UNDP

Leadership / Management

- ✓ Increase exposure of senior management (CDs, RRs and Deputies, and other staff on management track) to emergencies through secondments and detail assignments;
- ✓ Develop knowledge of corporate crisis management resources and tools through a 1-year roll-out programme of trainings (including simulations) in all regions.

Resource Mobilization

- ✓ Profile donors: identify funding priorities and interests, both thematic and geographic; develop RM packages with timelines for proposal development, application procedures and templates, pre-filled sample proposals and successful examples from other COs;
- ✓ Discuss with donors the inclusion of a standard clause in grants that allows UNDP to repurpose funds in case of emergency (up to a certain limit, such as 5% or USD 50,000) with prior consultation.
- ✓ Develop standard applications for CERF and for major donors on UNDP's Crisis Response Packages, that need only to be adjusted to local conditions. Share successful examples from other COs, that can be used as reference or inspiration;
- ✓ Develop key messages on UNDP's Crisis Response Packages for different target audiences (donors, humanitarian actors, national authorities) on why UNDP's activities are time-critical, life-saving, of a humanitarian nature or enabling humanitarian response; include these key messages in the CRPs;
- ✓ In developing resource mobilization tools, consider funding strategies for different contexts and how these can affect UNDP's access to resources, such as: low-income country/protracted crises/strong humanitarian presence; middle income country/sudden onset emergency/very limited humanitarian presence; middle income country/slow onset emergency/moderate humanitarian presence and so on;
- ✓ Provide guidance in the CRPs and CSOPs on how to design a chapeau document focused on response, recovery and resilience building – including template, examples, guidance on the timeline to develop and use it for resource mobilization, taking example from the BiH "Framework Programme".

Corporate SOPs and Crisis Response Packages (CRPs)

- ✓ Add to initial response actions the elaboration of a simple, immediate chapeau document that highlights the key elements of UNDP's response and recovery, and provides coherence to programming and RM efforts. The document will be further refined as the crisis develops and it will evolve in the more detailed recovery vision or strategy included in the SURGE Plan;
- ✓ Include in CSOPs and CRPs guidance for the elaboration of the chapeau document, a template, samples for different types of crises or examples from past UNDP crisis responses;
- ✓ Adopt an opt-out approach to crisis level declaration to simplify and speed up the initial phase of its response. At the Crisis Board and in the CO automatically adopt IASC crisis level, unless there is reason to increase/decrease it.
- ✓ Develop checklists of 'What to do in the first 72 hours' for the Response Pillar, Operations Pillar and Advocacy Pillar, indicating responsibilities of COs, Regional Hubs and HQ, for the different emergency levels;
- ✓ Ensure that Corporate SOPs, all CRPs, tools and resources developed for crisis response and

recovery are easily available in the intranet, and are not mixed up with older versions or non-relevant content.

- ✓ Complement the CRPs by adding (or expanding) the following tools:
 - A library of examples, lessons learned and good practices from other COs, that can be perused for reference and for inspiration in programme design, programme implementation and monitoring;
 - Resource mobilization tools and templates (see Recommendations on RM);
 - Gender equality programming tools and templates (see Recommendations on Gender);
 - A checklist on minimum and recommended data and information that should be available before an emergency, to facilitate needs assessment and subsequent programming. Use as an example OCHA's guidance on common operational datasets and functional operational datasets (CODs/FODs), and similar guidance;
 - A checklist for 'quality assurance' that indicate minimum standards for projects and programmes design, implementation and monitoring;
 - Tools for real-time evaluation or assessment of the crisis response;
 - Standard templates in official languages for MoUs, LoAs and Stand-By Agreements that COs can easily and quickly complete.

Gender equality

- ✓ Develop and disseminate tools and checklists for gender programming (based for example on the "Adapt and Act Collectively" framework) customized to UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ Train staff on gender equality in humanitarian action, starting with high-risk countries. Use for example the standard trainings by GenCap or UN Women, and add specific modules on how to integrate a gender perspective in UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ Train staff on gender equality in recovery, starting with high-risk countries. Develop training modules on how to integrate a gender perspective in UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ Review all Guidance Notes in the CRPs to foster a more comprehensive gender approach. While the Guidance Notes include a section on Women's participation and empowerment, and occasionally reference women in other sections, this can be expanded to a more complete gender approach to response and recovery. Suggested reviews include:
 - A gender analysis of the situation, and tools to assess key gender issues within the existing needs assessments tools and guidance (ex. Under "Key assessment considerations");
 - Mainstreaming of the gender perspective in the programme strategy and specific gender-transformative strategies and actions, including successful examples from past responses;
 - Guidance and examples of how to ensure a gender approach in operations and with partners;
 - Specific tools for the monitoring of progress on gender equality; examples of gender-sensitive and gender-transformative indicators
 - Gender-sensitive and gender-transformative communication tools and key messages;
 - Strategies and practical examples on how to ensure a gender approach in response and recovery project implementation.

PDNA

- ✓ Engage with the World Bank and the EU to review the 2008 Tripartite Agreement and related guidance and protocols; develop a common approach at country level for leadership and management of the PDNA, and ensure the minimum conditions for a quality

process and results;

- ✓ Develop an internal guidance for COs and Senior Management on how to engage with the PDNA process, its key partners EU and World Bank, and the national authorities, and how to navigate the common challenges presented by the PDNA.
- ✓ Include in the “National Disaster Recovery Planning and Coordination” CRP a light guide to the PDNA (the current guidance on procedures and 18 sectorial volumes while thorough can be overwhelming);
- ✓ Include in the “National Disaster Recovery Planning and Coordination” CRP a short guide and checklist on how to include a gender perspective in the PDNA (for reference, see Annex I of the PDNA Guidelines Volume B – Gender);
- ✓ Adapt and disseminate the tools, templates and guidance developed for the BiH PDNA to assess the damages and losses suffered by public administration (such as the value of lost records and documentation), add them to the existing guidance on PDNA.

Operations

- ✓ Develop a tool for supplies and budget estimation/calculation for Crisis Response Packages, with prices for standard kits, and prices for items available through the global LTAs;
- ✓ Develop guidance for local LTAs or Stand-by Agreements for supplies and services that UNDP is likely to require in crisis response and recovery, in particular for those related to its Crisis Response Packages; include standard specification, ToRs, examples from other COs;
- ✓ Develop guidance for pre-qualification of suppliers as a preparedness measure; include templates, specifications and examples from COs in the CRPs;
- ✓ Develop guidance for the “Expression of Interest” procedure for suppliers as a preparedness measure, include templates, specifications and examples from COs in the CRPs;
- ✓ Develop guidance (including advantages, disadvantages and alternative options), templates and checklists for prepositioning of supplies and equipment, for each of UNDP’s Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ In areas susceptible to need a temporary field office, pre-position prefabs and office equipment (ex. “Office in a box”); develop a checklist of minimum requirements for setting up a field office.

CO preparedness

- ✓ Institute a corporate policy of minimum CO preparedness, monitored annually. Minimum preparedness levels should be included as criteria for annual management evaluation.
- ✓ All low-risk COs should have in place, at any given time, a set of minimum measures, including:
 - The basic Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
 - The basic Emergency Preparedness Plan, including Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
 - Preparedness step-up triggers to start Enhanced preparedness if certain conditions are met.
- ✓ All medium- risk COs should have in place an Enhanced CO preparedness, including:
 - The expanded Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
 - The expanded Emergency Preparedness Plan, including enhanced Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners. Requirements for these MPAs would be more extensive or more detailed than the requirements for low-risk COs.
- ✓ Finally, the organization should identify the 20/25 COs with the highest risk (and history) of crisis and invest, on a no-regret basis, sufficient resources for a high level of preparedness.

It is likely that in many of these countries, crises will happen and UNDP will have to respond. A good performance is not only desirable in the context of the individual crisis, it will also increase the overall credibility of the organization in the eyes of donors and of the other humanitarian actors, contributing to positioning UNDP more strongly in emergency response and recovery. Full CO preparedness should include:

- The expanded Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
- The expanded Emergency Preparedness Plan, including enhanced Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
- In-depth training of management and staff on crisis response and recovery;
- Annual emergency simulations;
- Development of an Emergency Response Plan;
- Coordination mechanisms with authorities and with humanitarian and development actors;
- Standby Agreements with partners;
- LTAs with local and regional suppliers;
- Prepositioning of supplies and equipment as necessary.

Strengthen national capacity

- ✓ Favour national staff (both Programmes and Operations) for secondments and emergency missions, with the commitment from staff to return to their COs for a minimum period of time after the end of the mission;
- ✓ Identify a national emergency advisor (either from Programmes or Operations) with sufficient longevity in the organization and detailed knowledge of country-specific resources and procedures to assist senior management, the emergency coordinator and SURGE staff if deployed.
- ✓ Strongly promote the inclusion of national staff in SURGE rosters;
- ✓ Train staff on the new Corporate SOPs and CRPs, as well as on crisis response operational procedures.

Recommendations for BiH Country Office

Preparedness

- ✓ Review and update the basic Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
- ✓ Develop a minimum Emergency Preparedness Plan, including Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
- ✓ Identify step-up triggers or early warning triggers for selected scenarios, to scale up preparedness or enter into early action mode, if certain conditions are met.

CO capacity

- ✓ Nominate staff who have participated in the response for inclusion in the SURGE rosters;
- ✓ Support the deployment of staff to SURGE missions or detail assignments;
- ✓ Train all staff (and especially new staff) on the new Corporate SOPs and CRPs.

Gender equality

- ✓ Train all staff on gender equality in humanitarian action and in recovery, focusing on programmatic areas currently addressed by the BiH CO (governance, local development, DRR and so on);

- ✓ Appoint a Gender Focal Point with adequate seniority and decision-making authority, supported by an Alternate Gender Focal Point in Programme;
- ✓ Constitute a Gender Equality Task Force responsible for gender mainstreaming in CO programmes and for the implementation of recommendations of the “lessons learned” exercise on gender equality in the response and recovery to floods. Start with the preparedness measures identified.

1. Introduction

UNDP's Strategic Plan (2014-2017) recognizes the importance of preparedness, response, early recovery and risk management as fundamental for resilience building and development. The Organization is committed to improve its performance in crisis response and recovery, and to become faster, more predictable and effective. Two initiatives in particular reflect this commitment: the development of **Crisis Response Packages (CRPs)**, and the corporate review of the UNDP **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for crisis response**.⁵

UNDP routinely analyzes its performance in crisis response and recovery, through different tools like evaluations and **After Action Reviews (AARs)**. AARs are critical exercises to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of the organization. They foster reflection on the response and the identification of lessons on what happened and why, what was learned, what follow-up action should be taken and how to do better next time. The purpose of AARs is to inform future actions by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations.

With this aim in mind, the organization conducted an AAR of the **response to floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH) in 2014**. Devastating floods in the spring of 2014 placed UNDP BiH Country Office (CO) at the heart of immediate response, handling debris management, mine risk awareness and mine clearance, coordination and information management. Humanitarian instruments financed these interventions, providing much needed seed-funds to kick-start early recovery activities. UNDP managed to rapidly design and implement projects with time-critical and life-saving impact on the crisis affected communities; it adopted an early recovery approach that bridged relief and recovery.

The organization mobilized ample resources for its recovery programmes, allowing a rapid transition between relief and recovery and a seamless return to the development pathway. The CO received 1.2 million USD in CERF grants, while for recovery activities it managed to mobilize more than 80 million USD⁶. It has been a successful example of a **well-managed and effective operation**, which raised substantial funding and implemented a remarkable, creative programme, integrated in the disaster management cycle.

The purpose of this Review is to analyze and document entry points, enabling factors and good practices of the response, and what can be learned to improve UNDP's future performance in the CO itself and globally as an organization. The AAR outcome will inform the revision of the SOPs for immediate crisis response, the revision of the Fast Track Procedures and the finalization of the Crisis Response Packages.

The **AAR Report** is organised in six parts: the *Introduction* and the explanation of the *Methodology* precede an *Analysis of the response*, which describes key elements such as management, resource mobilization, programmes and operations. The *Timeline of events*, included in the Annexes, complements this chapter. To contextualize findings, these are included in the narrative of the report and not listed separately. **They are provided in blue text**. The following chapter, *Successes and Challenges of the Response*, highlights the positive elements that have contributed to the floods response and its main achievements, as well as the gaps and challenges encountered. Finally, the report presents *Recommendations* to be taken forward by the organization and by the CO.

⁵ To distinguish the two versions of the Standard Operating Procedures, in this report the 2012 SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response) will be called "SOPs" while the current version under development (Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response) will be called "Corporate SOPs" or "CSOPs".

⁶ This figure includes resilience projects implemented under the recovery umbrella.

2. Methodology

The AAR was conducted remotely. Its objective was to reveal what elements contributed to or limited the response, while taking into consideration the SOPs revision and the finalization of CRPs; the methodology and the conventional questions of an AAR (what happened, what was supposed to happen, what went well, what could have gone better, what to do differently next time) were adapted to reflect this. The initial **desk review** was followed by a remote **consultation** with several units in UNDP Headquarters,⁷ to identify key issues to explore in the AAR and to complement the initial methodology.

The consultations with the BiH CO started with a **Focus Group Discussion** (FGD), complemented by six **individual interviews**. Three **follow-up interviews** took place for further data collection and in-depth discussion on specific issues.⁸ The preliminary research phase resulted in the “**Initial findings**”, shared with all AAR participants and now integrated in this Report.

The **AAR took place remotely** with participants attending from the BiH CO, the Istanbul Regional Hub and HQ Units.⁹ During the AAR, they validated the Initial findings and discussed key elements of the response, including management, resource mobilization, programmes, operations and CO preparedness. The outcomes of the AAR are documented in the present **Final Report**.

3. Analysis of the floods response

3.1. Context and background

In May 2014, following weeks of heavy rains in the entire region, Bosnia and Herzegovina suffered **massive flooding** in the Northern, Eastern and Central parts of the country. The floods affected also Serbia, Croatia and Kosovo; they caused extensive damage and destruction in urban and rural areas to housing, agriculture, non-agricultural economic activities, public services facilities and infrastructure. They affected approximately 27% of the population, or one million people in BiH alone, and around 50% of the country's municipalities.

BiH has a complex **governance structure** that is the result of the peace agreement following the 1992-1995 war: there is the State, and at a lower level there are two entities and the Brčko district. The two entities, the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina (FBiH) and the Republika Srpska (RS), govern roughly half of the state's territory each, while the Brčko district is a self-governing administrative unit part of both the Federation and Republika Srpska. The Federation is further divided into 10 cantons, subdivided into municipalities, while Republika Srpska is divided directly into municipalities. The multiple governance structures and the political rivalries among them affected the coordination of the immediate response and recovery; in fact, there was no declaration of a national emergency despite the extent of the crisis. Instead, the two entities and the Brčko district individually declared the state of emergency.

BiH has been recognised by the European Union (EU) as a “**potential candidate country**” for accession since 2003; the Stabilisation and Accession Agreement (SAA) was signed in 2008.

⁷ These included the Crisis Response Unit (CRU), the Bureau for Policy and Programme Support (BPPS), the Bureau for External relations and Advocacy (BERA), the Bureau for Management Support (BMS) and the Regional Hub in Istanbul.

⁸ See Annex 6.2 for the complete list of people interviewed.

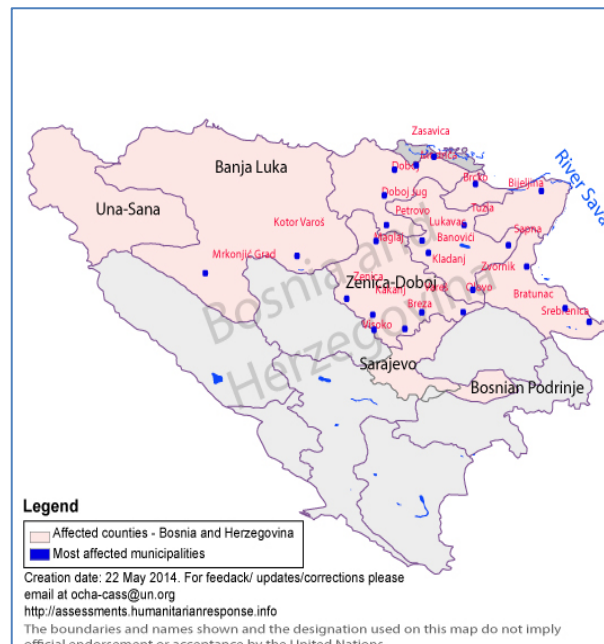
⁹ See Annex 6.3 for the complete list of participants.

The country has formally applied for EU membership on 15 February 2016. In the years after the war it recorded a sustained economic development, recently slowed down by the global crisis. At the time of the floods – the largest in 120 years – BiH had prioritized its accession to the EU and had not developed significant capacities on disaster risk management (DRM).

UNDP is present in BiH since 1996, and is now part of the One United Nations Programme. Its main areas of assistance in 2010-2014 were: rural and regional development, social inclusion and democratic governance, justice and security, and energy and environment. The new joint UN programme for 2015-2019 focuses on: reconciliation and inter-cultural dialogue, justice and security, sustainable livelihoods, social inclusion and the environment.

3.2. Management of the immediate crisis response

A few days before the floods, the water level of many rivers - including the one that passes through Sarajevo - was very high because of protracted heavy rains. It was an **early warning** of the floods to come. The Resident Coordinator (RC) immediately instructed the UN Country Team (UNCT) to prepare for the emergency, and assembled a **crisis response team (CRT)** with staff from UNDP and IOM; the authorities were alerted, but their initial attempts to coordinate the response failed, creating an opportunity for the UN to take a lead role. A liaison officer joined the 112 National Centre and provided an immediate and unfiltered flow of information; the regional offices of OCHA, UNDP and other agencies were informed of the impending emergency and had 2/3 days to prepare. UNDP CO started sourcing contracts, checking warehouses and taking other preparedness measures.



Experienced senior management recognized early warning signs of an impending crisis and took immediate preparedness and early actions (appointment of the Crisis Response Team (CRT), set-up of coordination and information management systems, immediate use of crisis response corporate tools). Early action positioned strongly the UN as a reliable and effective actor.

The weakness of the national coordination and response capacity opened up an opportunity for the UN to take the lead in coordination and response.

Once the floods hit, the **emergency was assigned a Level 2 category (L2)** in agreement with OCHA, thus not requiring a cluster system and a large surge of humanitarian staff. This decision took into consideration the extent of the damage, the capacities of the UNCT and of the response team, as well as BiH authorities' sensitivity about an external humanitarian response, which would have given a negative image for a country in pre-accession to the EU. The State did not declare a national emergency, and there was no UNDAC mission. The EU activated its Civil Protection mechanism; several national teams deployed and contributed supplies and equipment.

UNDP managed the crisis **internally as a Level 1 (L1)**, given the critical capacities available within the CO. The Resident Representative/Resident Coordinator and the Deputy RR are both experienced in crisis management, and several staff are experienced in crisis response and were previously deployed as SURGE Advisors.

The SOPs identify three criteria to determine the level of the organizational response: the nature and magnitude of the crisis, the impact on staff and the capacity of the CO to manage a response. The Corporate SOPs align UNDP with the IASC system in identifying the criteria for the response level as: capacity, scale, complexity, urgency and reputational risk. UNDP designation of the crisis level frequently matches the IASC one, but not always as the BiH case shows. A high level of internal CO capacity can balance other adverse factors, for example low national capacities in disaster management.

UN regional offices supported the in-country response: OCHA provided supplies and technical assistance for the CERF; WFP contributed high-energy biscuits; and the regional offices of the UN agencies on the ground, such as UNICEF, IOM, FAO, UNFPA contributed supplies and surge staff (approximately 10 persons in total).

Swift and coordinated action positioned the UN in the first week as a reliable player in the eyes of national and subnational authorities and donors. It increased the confidence of the state and entities on UN's ability to coordinate the response, a task it was eventually assigned. Preparedness and early actions were successful and paid off.

The RC established the **International Community Flood Coordination Meetings (ICFCM)**, held every other day for the first weeks, then twice a week, and eventually substituted by a recovery coordination mechanism. The coordination role played by the RC and UNDP was critical and very effective: all response actors, including donors, attended the ICFCM. On the 19th of May the UN introduced a coordination helpline with the objective of supporting donors and providing information about existing needs - this was one key step as UNDP became the **information and coordination hub** and the clearinghouse for quality information on needs, gaps, resources and response. During the initial phase of the response the UN was directly involved in many coordination activities, such as support to incoming emergency teams through custom clearance, liaison with the military, liaison with local authorities and so on.

The leadership role assumed by UNDP in coordination and information management gave further visibility to the quality and reliability of its response. Preparedness and rapid early action, effectiveness in coordination and information management, and the initial programmatic interventions positioned UNDP strategically at the centre of the response. This reinforced donors' confidence and was instrumental in securing the large funds UNDP later received for recovery programmes.

In parallel with actions on the ground, the CO immediately requested **corporate support**:

- TRAC funds for USD 100,000, promptly disbursed;
- Fast Track Procedures (FTPs), immediately approved, then extended for the whole year;
- Access to LTAs with UN Depots in Brindisi and Dubai through the Copenhagen Procurement Support Office (PSO).

The Regional Hub, alerted in advance by the CO, provided rapid approval to procurement requests that exceeded the CO FTPs thresholds, thus facilitating fast implementation and disbursement of funds. The CO did not request any other corporate support (for example SURGE deployments), as it was able to manage the crisis with internal resources and staff.

At the end of May, UN agencies applied for **CERF funds**, receiving around USD 2 million – of which UNDP received USD 1.2 million¹⁰ for debris management and mine action.

In the first half of June, UNDP opened three **field offices** in the affected areas (in Dobo, Tuzla and Brčko District) to support the response and recovery. It was a very smart decision: it gave the organization better access to affected areas and population; it facilitated quality data collection and needs assessments; it enabled evidence and needs-based programme interventions, and it provided direct support to some of the affected municipalities.

Field presence was a key element of UNDP's performance. The majority of other agencies did not have field presence and this constituted a distinct advantage for the organization.

ICFCM meetings continued, and modeling the cluster system, thematic coordination meetings started on health, education, water and sanitation, cash for work and economic empowerment, livelihoods and housing. There was not a separate coordination forum for early recovery. The CO considers coordination with other UN entities essential for the full coverage of needs and target groups. The CERF itself contributed to it as 3 UN agencies received funds and they strengthened their collaboration to avoid overlaps. The response phase lasted 4-6 weeks.

The EU took a prominent, visible role in coordination with the **Recovery Needs Assessment (RNA)** while the UN continued coordinating in the background. The RNA took place in the first half of June and its results were published on the 18th of June. The damages and losses amounted to nearly 15% of the country GDP; the hardest hit economic sectors were agriculture, transport and productive activities.

Thanks to UNDP's highly recognized performance during the response phase (and other reasons discussed later in the document), many donors funded UNDP's proposed recovery activities. Separate funding streams were grouped into the two main recovery programmes: the **UN Floods Recovery Programme (UN FRP)**, supported by over 38 recovery donors and partners for a total amount of USD 22 million, and the **EU Floods Recovery Programme (EU FRP)** for a total amount of EUR 43.53 million, funded mainly by the EU (42.25 million EUR, 1.28 million EUR funded by UNDP). These two programmes are discussed more in detail in Chapter 3.4.3.

3.3. Resource mobilization

The CO requested TRAC funds for USD 100,000 for **immediate response** (May to December 2014):

- Support to coordination, needs assessments, coordination meetings;
- Impacts assessments in 6 municipalities and recovery plans.

Together with other UN agencies, UNDP applied for CERF funds and received approximately USD 1.2 million from the Rapid Response window (June to December 2014):

- USD 715,000 for debris management;
- USD 500,000 for mine action.

CERF funds were easy to access, were disbursed quickly and enabled the immediate start of activities and assistance to the population. There is widespread consensus that these funds

¹⁰ More details on the evolution of the events are included in the Timeline in Annex 6.4, while information on the programmatic aspects of the response is treated in the Programme chapter.

were essential for UNDP to position itself strategically in the immediate response. They provided credibility as the organisation could mobilize its own resources and take over responsibilities that local authorities could not undertake alone (or at all); for example mine clearance and debris management, necessary to start the recovery process. Communication between agencies and their engagement in additional fundraising depended also on CERF funds.

The 2015 State of the Humanitarian System¹¹ shows that, despite the increase in funding (almost 20 billion USD in 2014), crises are longer and needs are deeper. Among the many consequences, there is also more competition for the funds available. If UNDP is not 'in the game' and a credible actor since the very beginning, resource mobilization both for humanitarian and for recovery funds will be difficult.

Initial funds in sufficient amounts (either internal resources like TRAC or humanitarian funds like CERF) are fundamental for the success of the response and for additional resource mobilization. Seed funds give the organization the resources to start a response early on, positioning it in the humanitarian landscape (where it might have not been strong or even present). They boost its credibility vis-à-vis donors, as the organization is able to match funds with its own resources; they might provide opportunities or leverage to negotiate for joint interventions with other humanitarian actors, multiplying the results.

UNDP's share of the CERF funds for BiH represents around **60% of the total allocation**, an exceptional allocation compared to UNDP's usual rates. CERF provides Rapid Response grants only for "life-saving activities"; this has been a reason to deny the inclusion of UNDP's projects in past CERF applications (for example, in the response to Tropical Cyclone Pam in 2015). In BiH, the nature of interventions might have contributed to the allocation. The rationale for life-saving and time-critical action was well articulated: activities included the "safe removal of hazardous and potential *health damaging waste*"; Cash for Work grants were linked to the *emergency* employment database; debris management would facilitate "provision for humanitarian assistance and precondition for recovery". Mine clearance is life-saving. The majority of needs identified were in sectors in which UNDP has broad experience and a clear added value (for example debris management).

The context of the floods response was also decisive: BiH is a country in pre-accession phase to the European Union, which has experienced a steady economic growth after the war (despite the recent economic crisis) and enjoys a certain level of development. Even with the massive damage caused by the floods, the country and the population had resources; many displaced people stayed with family members, the vast majority had access to food, water and sanitation, health and so on. It was not a catastrophic humanitarian situation and there were limited "classic" humanitarian needs like food, shelter, access to WASH and health. In another context, where traditional humanitarian needs might be more pronounced, there would be perhaps fewer chances for UNDP to receive CERF money, destined instead to more basic needs.

The limited presence of other humanitarian actors reduced competition; other UN agencies either were not present in country, like WFP, or had at the beginning limited operational and absorption capacity, like UNICEF (although they did scale up their presence afterwards). In this context, UNDP as one of the leading organisations in the response had easier access to CERF funds.

The successful mobilization of humanitarian funds originates in:

¹¹ The State of the Humanitarian System (ALNAP, 2015) <http://sohs.alnap.org/#longer-crises>

- UNDP's demonstrated ability to deliver (thanks to the immediate performance guaranteed by initial TRAC funds, field presence, coordination and information management role);
- The time-critical and/or life-saving character of intended actions;
- A limited presence and capacity of traditional humanitarian agencies;
- Assessed needs in line with UNDP's expertise and added value.

Donors appreciated UNDP's responsiveness and resource mobilization capacity, and trusted it with more resources; they acknowledged that UNDP's requests were based on needs assessments and on its capacity to reach out to local authorities and communities. In the meantime, national authorities were unable to produce a National Recovery Plan. Both Norway and US, non-traditional donors in BiH, recognized UNDP's speed and competence (as well as their own limitations regarding rapid procurement) and provided more funds for early recovery and recovery. Good performance on these funds was in turn instrumental in raising more substantive recovery funding from other donors, such as the European Union. The CO was able to issue immediate, clear financial reports thanks to the financial architecture created in its internal systems (Atlas) for this complex operation. Reportedly, this increased donors' confidence and expedited their disbursement of subsequent tranches once the first ones were spent and rapidly accounted for.

The successful mobilization of recovery funds derived from:

- The effective delivery on humanitarian funds, showing UNDP's capacity and reliability;
- A rapid, efficient reporting on funds received, increasing donor's trust on the organization's absorption capacity to manage further resources;
- An evidence-based recovery programme design;
- The lack of a National Recovery Plan, which directed funds to UNDP instead of national programmes.

Recovery funds mobilized are grouped into 2 main programmes: the EU Floods Recovery Programme, and the UN Floods Recovery Programme. The **EU Floods Recovery Programme (EU FRP)** is a 43.53million EUR programme, funded mainly by the EU with a 42.25 million EUR, and a EUR 1.28 million UNDP contribution. Implemented by UNDP, UNICEF and IOM, it is based on the RNA. The EU was slow in fund allocation, as it does not have emergency funds available for countries in pre-accession phase; instead, it redirected financial resources under the Instrument for Pre-Accession (IPA). It's a favourable circumstance that these funds were already allocated to the BiH portfolio. The UN had demonstrated its capacity and without a National Recovery Plan it was the natural choice for recovery funds. UNDP agreed to pre-finance some operations against the EU commitment to reimburse funded activities later.

The **UN Floods Recovery Programme (UN FRP)** is a USD 22 million framework programme supported by many bilateral donors (38 different partners in total, including Norway, Japan, DFID, USAID, ECHO and multiple levels of Government of BiH). It was implemented with UNICEF, IOM, FAO, UNFPA, between July 2014 and September 2015.

A few weeks after the floods, when the CERF-funded response was already under way, UNDP designed a framework programme encompassing all detected needs – including both response and recovery - but it did not develop separate funding proposals in advance. Once donors were interested either in providing non-earmarked assistance, or in funding a particular segment of the programme, the two parties agreed and UNDP developed short

project proposals. The fact that several major donors contributed to the UN FRP had a magnet effect in attracting other funds.

The programme was developed during the response phase and the Framework document included response activities, showing the continuity and coherence of the approach, aimed at linking response and recovery. The programme was based on the results of the RNA, and activities were decided with the relevant authorities, for example with health authorities for the rehabilitation of health facilities, with education authorities for the rehabilitation of schools and kindergartens. It included as well the so-called “orphan projects”, which had limited scope and linkages with other activities, but were extremely necessary. Chapter 3.4.3 examines the framework programme more in detail.

The factors that contributed to the UN FRP resource mobilization were:

- The development of an evidence-based, comprehensive framework programme in the first 4-6 weeks after the floods, linking relief, recovery and the transition back to development and resilience;
- The flexibility it gave donors to fund parts of the programmes in which they were interested;
- The flexibility to include small scale or self contained projects in parallel with broader activities;
- The joint implementation with other UN agencies, which required channelling of the funds through UNDP for administrative reasons;
- The magnet effect for smaller donors.

3.4. Programmes

3.4.1. Assessments

UNDP conducted **immediate assessments** within a few days of the floods (starting on May 22nd) and multiple field visits in the most affected areas. It did not request support from the Regional Hub or other COs. The field offices and previous programmes were instrumental in guaranteeing access to the affected areas, local authorities, local organizations and the communities themselves, in identifying urgent needs and priorities.

Data from these and other initial assessments, conducted with local authorities and other organisations, fed into the ICFCM information management system; over time assessment quality improved because the UN coordination hub vetted them; this in turn improved reliability of the evidence offered and increased UN’s credibility and donors’ trust.

After initial guidance from the UN, the EU directed the **Recovery Needs Assessment (RNA)**, with a team led by the Nobel Prize Ricardo Zapata, and with participation of the UN and the World Bank. The RNA started with the teams’ training at the end of May, and took place at the beginning of June; each organisation contributed staff, some led the assessment of one or more sectors; UNDP was in charge of livelihoods (together with ILO), housing and cross-cutting issues. The RNA analysed agriculture, education, health, public services and facilities, housing, energy, livelihoods, transport, water and sanitation. The RNA states that the floods have caused the equivalent of nearly 15 % of GDP in damages (9.3 % of GDP) and losses (5.6 %). Agriculture, transport and productive activities were the hardest hit economic sectors; the economy of Bosnia and Herzegovina was expected to contract by 0.7 % in 2014.

According to CO informants, capacities varied widely among the organisations participating in the RNA; some policy-centered organisations, based in Sarajevo only, had less capacity

(and sometimes were also reluctant) to collect data in the field. UNDP, thanks to its field offices and the good relationship with local authorities, was instead well positioned for the work. The coordination among agencies was good: the EU set up an office for the RNA teams to work together, which enabled communication and coordination.

During the RNA, the CO received short-term support from CRU Geneva: the Urban Risk Management and PDNA Specialist participated in the RNA design, for approximately two weeks. Technical support was necessary on how to assess recovery needs for the public administration, for example on how to determine the monetary value of lost vital records and documentation. Existing PDNA guidelines do not address this particular issue, tools and templates had to be devised specifically for BiH. The RNA suffered enormous time constraints, as it had to be completed within 3 weeks; its results were published in the second half of June, but they did not lead to a National Recovery Plan. Neither of the two entities (FBiH and RS) produced a Recovery Plan; this opened up an opportunity for UNDP because donors, who normally would channel resources through national mechanisms, instead directed their funds to UNDP.

Both FBiH and RS exerted very strong political pressure on RNA outcomes. Damage and losses figures had to be negotiated with the entities; as a result they are grossly inflated, according to several informants. Although figures are not always accurate, the proportion breakdown and the needs identified are considered realistic.

The **gender** component of the RNA was insufficient and warranted a separated report by UN Women: “Gender Equality in Post-Disaster Needs Assessment in Bosnia-Herzegovina”. The report provides an overview of the different flood impacts on women and men, their implications for recovery, and recommendations to address disaster-related needs caused or worsened by discrimination against women.

According to the report: “Gender inequality in Bosnia-Herzegovina has significant implications for disaster recovery. While the country is one of the most advanced on legislation and policy on gender equality, there is little political will for its implementation. Women are largely excluded from political and decision-making processes; they have disproportionately limited access to employment and income, and many are subject to violence. There is particular concern with respect to Roma women in BiH, who are even more severely disadvantaged and marginalized. Resilience-building against future shocks will require attention and funds directed toward reducing the severe economic and decision-making disparities between women and men.” Key Recommendations include:

1. Equal and meaningful participation of women from all groups in all recovery decision-making forums
2. Equitable and transparent land, housing and property restitution for men and women, with well-publicized criteria and procedures
3. Default joint titling/ joint registration of recovery-assisted land and housing for couples
4. Strengthened economic empowerment programs for women as part of DRR
5. Gender-sensitive disaster preparedness, response and recovery planning

The quality of the RNA was reduced by the very short timeframe available, the strong political pressures that required a revision of the damages and losses estimations, the limited integration of a proper gender perspective.

3.4.2. Immediate crisis response and early recovery

The CO started the **immediate response** thanks to TRAC funds (May to December 2014), which included:

- Support to coordination, needs assessments, coordination meetings;
- Impacts assessments in 6 municipalities and recovery plans.

It redirected funds, with the agreement of the donors (Sweden and Switzerland), from its Integrated Local Development Programme to early recovery activities like support to farmers and public service restoration. The positive relationship with the donors allowed for an immediate consultation on re-channeling resources; donors accepted UNDP's recommendations to respond.

It appears that seed funding (either through TRAC funds or by redirecting existing resources) to kick-start the response is critical, particularly if CERF grants may not be available because of competing funding allocation to other humanitarian actors.

CERF-funded activities (June to December 2014) comprised:

- Debris management, including Cash for Work (CfW) activities;
- Mine risk awareness and mine clearance.

UNDP did not continue mine action activities after the conclusion of CERF, leaving them to other actors. The use of CERF grants for early recovery activities, in line with the UNDP Crisis Response Packages, complemented the TRAC 1.1.3 cat.2 immediate funding response.

The **Cash for Work (CfW)** modality was used mainly for debris management; at the time it was the greatest need and it provided immediate financial support to the most vulnerable groups; this in turn was very beneficial for the acceptance of the programme. The criteria for selection of the beneficiaries included age, sex (30% women), unemployment status, and returnee status. UNDP verified the lists provided, signed Letters of Agreement (LoAs) with the municipalities, and transferred them the funds after the end of works. Beneficiaries were trained on work safety and mine risk, and UNDP conducted monitoring visits through its field offices. At the end, the project underwent a financial audit. Despite the significant amount of paperwork involved, the CO considers the CfW experience very positive and would repeat it in similar circumstances, extending it to other types of activities where feasible.

In its programmes, UNDP adopted **an early recovery approach** that bridged immediate crisis response activities with recovery interventions, leading back to development. Debris management was complemented by rehabilitation of community infrastructure and livelihoods support; mine action complemented debris management to allow for safe delivery of response and recovery interventions; emergency employment through CfW was granted to the most vulnerable among those affected by floods, and later on these same groups were targeted for livelihood recovery support. Chapter 3.4.2 analyzes these linkages more in detail.

3.4.3. Recovery

UN Floods Recovery Programme (UN FRP)

The Programme was funded by many bilateral donors, primarily Norway, Japan, USAID, DFID, ECHO and multiple levels of Government of BIH (for a total of 38 different recovery partners); it was implemented with UNICEF, IOM, FAO, and UNFPA. The overall goal of the

UN FRP was “to assist floods response and recovery efforts, contributing to safety of the population and infrastructure, and to the restoration of the public services and livelihoods.” It included:

- **Livelihoods** support: Cash for work, distribution of livestock feed, bovine vaccines, wheat seeds and greenhouses for small-scale agriculture projects;
- Water, Sanitation and Hygiene projects (**WASH**), restoration of water supplies and sewage systems;
- Rehabilitation of **health centers** through procurement of the necessary medical equipment and medical vehicles;
- Reconstruction and refurbishment of two **elderly centers** with modern and adequate equipment for healthy ageing;
- **Stabilisation of landslides** through donation of drainage pipes and geo nets in the selected municipalities;
- Rehabilitation of the central **heating system** in Dobo;
- Rehabilitation of infrastructure through reconstruction of local bridges;
- Improving the **value chain in the dairy industry** of the Zenica-Dobo Canton;
- Reconstruction and rehabilitation of **public institutions**, including schools, hospitals, kindergartens, cultural centres, libraries, and theaters;
- Assistance to **social inclusion** process through financing the refurbishment of school and sport playgrounds and the organisation of summer camps for children from the flooded areas; community-based psychosocial support to displaced persons, care givers and disaster relief workers; group psycho social counseling;
- Development of a UN Recovery Database, whose objective is to capture the results of the recovery projects, especially interventions and products delivered, as well as to provide geographical and structural data on them;
- Gender mainstreaming analysis.

The CO developed it as a “**framework programme**” integrating multiple projects; each of them was not immediately developed as a fully-fledged project but only outlined; when donors expressed interest in funding a component, then the CO developed a short project proposal. This innovative shortcut was supported by management and made possible by the good relation with donors, who did not always request a lengthy proposal before financing activities; it is efficient, as it avoids drafting proposals that might not be funded afterwards. It should be considered as an element to be included in the SURGE Plan (with corresponding guidance in the CSOPs and CRPs) to promote rapid proposal writing. The resource mobilization window can be very short, and UNDP has lost opportunities in the past because it did not manage to develop proposals on time.

The UN FRP also included what the CO calls “orphan projects”: small projects with limited scope and limited linkages with other activities, but highly necessary. One such example is the rehabilitation of the Dobo central heating system that had to be repaired before the start of the cold season, to provide heating to 40,000 people.

Some other projects funded under the UN FRP include:

- The “**Durable Housing Solutions for Flood and Landslide Affected Households in Bosnia and Herzegovina**” project (USD 2.3 million, April 2015 to March 2016, funded by USAID and multiple levels of Government of BiH) whose objective was to provide a durable housing solution for 150 vulnerable households (100 in the FBiH and 50 in the RS) permanently displaced. It promoted a DRR approach by ensuring that no investments are made in areas vulnerable to floods or landslides.
- “**Support to flood recovery and risk mitigation**” (USD 1.87 million, February 2015 to

February 2016 and extended to June 2016, funded by DFID and multiple levels of Government of BiH). More geared towards DRR, this project aims at protecting investments made in recovery, at building back better, and at encouraging prevention. It was designed to complement existing activities and to address some of the remaining early recovery and immediate prevention needs, in particular the restoration of water and sanitation public services, and technical measures for flood defence. It complements the rehabilitation of public facilities and housing by other recovery projects in the same affected areas.

- The “**Landslide Disaster Risk Management**” project (USD 3.8 million, March 2015 to June 2016, funded by Japan and multiple levels of Government of BiH). It aims at strengthening landslide management capacity of the local governments, through remediation and risk mitigation measures for 10 priority landslide sites, and tailored technical assistance and training on improvement of cadastres to local governments. It includes an analysis of existing legal, institutional and policy frameworks related to landslides management in BiH.

EU Floods Recovery Programme

The **EU Floods recovery programme** was based on the results of the RNA. It started in August 2014 and ended in February 2016. Its overall objective was to “aid the post-disaster recovery of flood affected localities in BiH by addressing critical gaps identified through the RNA”. It had three specific objectives:

- Emergency housing rehabilitation, reconstruction of dwellings for most vulnerable;
- Rehabilitation and restoration of public services and facilities (education, health, welfare, administration); communal infrastructure: roads and bridges; water and sanitation infrastructure;
- Livelihoods support: Assistance to farmers, and micro, small and medium enterprises to restore their economic activities; Job creation and retention.

Its components were designed to mutually reinforce each other: for example, livelihoods support was given to the most vulnerable groups, who also received housing support. The RNA in fact recommended that shelter recovery were linked to livelihoods restoration, allowing returnees and other vulnerable groups to generate income and thus promoting economic recovery and development. The EU FRP included several DRR measures especially for rehabilitated public facilities, aimed at protecting the investments made and at ensuring sustainability.

3.4.4. Linkages between pre-disaster, immediate response, early recovery and recovery activities; sustainability and accountability

At the time of the floods, the CO had several **programmes already in place**: DRR projects, programmes on local governance and on integrated local development. These represented an asset for the response: some of their funds could be redirected for immediate activities; in addition, through these programmes UNDP already had an established field presence, essential for data collection and needs assessments. Thanks to these activities, it had developed positive relations with local authorities and local organisations; this allowed for a swift collaboration in the immediate response and in recovery afterwards. One of the projects for example supported CSOs in providing social welfare services to the most vulnerable groups.

This **network of associates** (local authorities and civil society organisations) was a resource

that few other UN organisations had; only UNICEF and IOM had significant field activities, while many other agencies were mostly based in Sarajevo and centered on policy support. These associates provided UNDP with information, contacts, collaboration, and facilitated the delivery of assistance. The support was reciprocal: when UNDP opened three additional field offices, they were of great help to local authorities that had lost their structures (for example in Maglaj).

The **nature of programmes** also linked pre-floods activities with response and recovery: BiH CO had been involved for a long time in construction and reconstruction after the war; when housing rehabilitation and reconstruction were planned and then implemented, the staff was already experienced on the matter and could provide a high-quality response. The same applies to the local development programme pre-dating the floods: this had a sizable livelihood component, which could be converted in Cash for Work activities, then in early recovery and livelihoods recovery support. Now, after the end of the recovery phase, activities are transitioning back to normal programmes, completing the cycle.

The CO strived for a **seamless transition between response, early recovery and recovery activities**. As it prepared the response, it kept early recovery and recovery in mind. For example, it detected the immediate need for animal fodder, necessary for the cattle that had not perished in the floods. Because farmers had lost their crops, they could not feed the cattle, and there was a significant risk that without a swift intervention, they would adopt negative coping strategies like slaughtering the cattle, further damaging their own livelihoods. Providing fodder therefore responded to the immediate need, but also had a protective effect on recovery and avoided further economic damage. Later on, this intervention was complemented with the distribution of fodder seeds.

Response and recovery projects **consistently targeted the most vulnerable groups**, such as returnees, beneficiaries of social welfare and social care centres, unemployed, single parents and Roma people. The debris management activities and the CfW initiative provided quick employment to the most vulnerable categories, focusing on six floods affected areas. In another case, different components of a recovery programme mutually reinforced each other, by providing livelihoods support to the same target group that received housing support, to increase their chances for economic recovery. The same approach was adopted by the durable housing project under the UN floods recovery framework: it seeks synergies with the livelihoods/economic recovery components of parallel recovery projects.

The EU programme links with UNDP Integrated Local Development Project, on the local development strategies to be designed after the disaster. The development baseline and targets will have to be adjusted because of the crisis, and this will provide an opportunity to include DRR and climate change mechanisms into the strategic documents. The “Floods and Landslides Housing Risk Assessment” completed under the EU recovery programme will be used to inform any DRR/DRM strategies developed by local authorities in the floods affected areas; as well as in the “Landslides management” project, which has a strong DRR approach. Another example that further shows the cyclic nature of disaster risk management is the inclusion of a curriculum on DRR and emergency management (developed on the basis of the experience with the 2014 floods) within the municipal training plans of the local governance programme.

According to CO reports, the consequences of the floods and the inclusion of DRR and resilience measures in local development activities have raised the profile of DRM in BiH, provoking more debate and public discussion on the need to increase resilience and to manage risks better.

Existing programmes can successfully contribute to crisis response: their resources can be temporarily employed for the emergency; the contacts, relations, networks and

other intangible assets generated can (and should) be used for a rapid, efficient and effective response. On the same line, programmatic linkages between existing activities, response, recovery, DRR and resilience strengthening increase programme quality.

All recovery projects benefitted from a risk assessment, undertaken by UNDP Programme. The assessment was deemed as a critical prerequisite for **sustainable recovery**, indicating where not to invest because of the high risk of further flooding or landslides.

The CO took several measures to strengthen **accountability, especially to the affected population**. Some of the measures reported by the CO include the participation of seven different domestic institutions in the advisory panel that oversaw UNDP's recovery portfolio; weekly reports to the national government; UNDP's participation in the Solidarity Funds (or flood recovery mechanisms) of both entities; daily contacts with local governments and NGOs through field offices. The CO also introduced built-in appeal mechanisms in all programmes where beneficiaries, or prospective beneficiaries, could voice their grievances; and a quality assurance mechanism for all works performed where beneficiaries could decide whether to accept works from the contractors, thus giving the beneficiaries full ownership of the process.

Nevertheless, the CO reports that local ownership of the response sometimes was limited, and that in select communities political consideration overshadowed the need to assist the population. This resulted on occasions in limited accountability to the affected population.

3.4.5. Gender equality programming

The integration of gender equality in the response and recovery activities could have been stronger.

The CO did not conduct a proper **gender analysis** prior to programme design; it did not have a Gender Specialist and it did not request technical support on gender programming. The CO currently has a Gender Focal Point, whose main role is Programme Analyst, and it does not have plans to recruit a Gender Programme Officer.

The CERF project documents do not indicate any gender-specific activities, although in the Annual Report on the use of CERF grants, gender equality is indicated as one of the funding allocation criteria. The reports mention that CERF projects targeted approximately 560,000 people, of which 285,000 were women and 275,000 men.

Some gender equality measures were implemented: a minimum of 30% of women were selected for Cash for Work activities, and they were assigned suitable debris management work; female-headed households received assistance in priority. At the same time, simple measures were overlooked: the CO did not purchase clothing and equipment for people employed by CfW schemes on different sizes for male and female (see also Operations chapter). The CO justifies this with market shortages; however, when some items are not available locally, they are usually sourced elsewhere.

The recovery projects also included some gender equality measures: in the housing rehabilitation projects, 30% was reserved for female-headed households; women-led enterprises or SMEs that employed a higher number of women (30-60%) received higher or even maximum scores and therefore were prioritized for livelihoods recovery support. These measures are not sufficient: according to one interim report of the UN FRP, jobs created or retained for women are only the 20% of the total jobs created or retained in the reporting

period. Women-led businesses supported are only 16% of the total number of businesses supported.

While the activities described above are positive, they are not sufficient to mainstream a gender perspective; a more comprehensive and structured approach is needed.

The CO has identified **gender-responsive activities** that could have been implemented: ensuring a sufficient number of female members or women's organisations representatives within the local or municipal committees for beneficiary selection; sensitizing the committees on gender equality, to enable them to conduct an equitable selection.

The integration of gender perspective in needs assessments (including the RNA), programme design and programme implementation, although not completely lacking was insufficient and can be improved.

The CO itself recognizes that it could have better integrated gender equality in the immediate response and in recovery programming. Some of the reasons stated for the limited gender response are: the lack of preparedness; the lack of available data and specific information on women, on how to better target and reach them; the lack of internal capacity; the pressure and fast pace of crisis response; finally, the complexity of coordination which did not allow for some issues to be adequately considered.

While it is a frequent rationalization in crisis response across organizations and countries, the "tyranny of the urgent" is not a justification for the lack of a gender perspective in programmes. All efforts must be made to ensure gender and diversity considerations, especially in crisis response. Crises exacerbate existing inequalities; by ensuring the integration of a gender perspective in its response and recovery programmes, UNDP has the opportunity to build back better not only what has been physically destroyed but also to build a better and more equitable society.

3.5. Operations

The CO did not request operational support to HQ or RH in form of **deployments**, as in-house capacity was sufficient. In fact, at least one of the members of the Operations team is a SURGE Advisor and has participated in SURGE missions, is familiar with crisis response procedures and tools and has crisis response experience.

The CO requested activation of **Fast Track Procedures** (FTPs), immediately granted and later renewed for a full year. The CO already had an increased delegation of authority on procurement up to USD 300,000; the activation of the FTP automatically raised the threshold to USD 500,000 which contributed to its capacity to take decisions and commitments without prior approval of Regional or HQ Committees.

Contracts above USD 500,000 were submitted – as per UNDP regulations – to the **Regional APC**, while those above USD 2 million to the HQ APC. Under the FTPs, these Committees are required to take a decision within 48 hours instead of the customary 7-10 days; the CO informed in advance the APCs that they would receive such requests and therefore they were ready to take immediate action. According to the CO, the responsiveness of the Regional and HQ Committees has contributed to the rapidity of the response and to UNDP's capacity to deliver.

The CO profited of the **global LTAs** with the UN Depots in Brindisi and Dubai through Copenhagen Procurement Support Office (PSO); thanks to these agreements the CO could access the list of supplies and equipment available and their price; many items were purchased, while others that were not available like mud pumps had to be bought

elsewhere. According to the CO, in case of floods mud pumps are always necessary; it would be useful to have some in stock in the UN Depots.

Although limited only to the actions listed above, corporate support to the CO greatly facilitated the delivery of a rapid response. Fast Track Procedures allowed for increased spending authority, which permitted faster turnaround and delivery times in selecting and contracting providers, disbursing funds and so on, ultimately accelerating the response; the global LTAs gave the CO immediate access to needed equipment and supplies.

As the critical part of the construction activities took place in July and August, the CO decided to conduct a **market analysis** to verify if construction companies would be able to respond to UNDP needs; July and August are the peak season in construction, and the majority of companies are already engaged in activities. For this reason, the CO published an **“Expression of Interest”** call for all construction companies locally and in neighbouring countries, in advance of the tender. Several dozen companies responded, and UNDP could assess market capacities. In the future, this good practice could be further strengthened by complementary preparedness measures such as pre-qualification of providers, or LTAs or Stand-by Agreements with pre-selected companies.

Schools and kindergartens had to reopen before September 1st; when funds arrived, UNDP published the tenders and send notices to the companies that had responded to the EoI; the tenders were open for up to 10 days thanks to shortened FTPs requirements, and the selection took only 48 hours. The entire process took 2 or 3 weeks, a considerable reduction on its usual 2-months duration. The Expression of Interest proved very useful to speed up the procedure once the funds became available; it could be considered for inclusion in the CRPs as a good practice, when the capacity of the market to respond to increased needs is not immediately clear.

The right early actions or preparedness actions by the Operations team (such as the market analysis and EoI described above) can increase and accelerate the delivery capacity of the CO, contributing to its performance.

UNDP was able to disburse and implement CERF funds rapidly, thanks to the collaboration with local authorities and municipalities, with whom the organisation already had a good working relationship. Disbursement to partners took on average 7 days; through the LoAs UNDP disbursed a total of USD 250,000. Existing LTAs, accessed through the Copenhagen Procurement Support Office (PSO), allowed for immediate or very quick procurement of supplies and equipment.

An important challenge the CO experienced was the **work overload**: the major increase in operations led to a large scale-up and to an extraordinary workload; according to an estimation from General Services, before the floods the CO managed around 150 contracts per year, which increased to 350/400 during the response and recovery phase. The CO was successful in scaling up, but it could have benefitted from a larger temporary increase in staff. Another challenge encountered were the **short deadlines** for funds expenditure (18 months). These can be problematic for construction activities, since they can only take place in certain seasons and not all year long.

4. Successes and challenges of the response

4.1. Key successes of the response and enabling factors

Many factors contributed to the successful response and recovery managed by the BiH CO:

Leadership: One of the most critical success factors was leadership. Experienced senior management provided the right guidance by initiating preparedness and early response actions, using corporate tools available, rapidly taking critical decisions, anticipating and addressing potential difficulties. It also supported national staff in running the response and endorsed unusual but innovative approaches that proved to be successful.

Both the RC and the Deputy Resident Representative have a strong background and experience on emergency management, and are well versed on UNDP's crisis response and recovery capacity and instruments. The RC has 15 years of experience on crisis management, had just returned from a detail assignment in the Philippines on Hayaan response; the Deputy had previously worked in crisis management and in BCPR.

The management not only had the abstract knowledge on how to direct the response but also the practical intelligence that comes from experience, enabling them to make critical decisions quickly and to anticipate potential problems. For example, management immediately decided to establish a Crisis Response Team (CRT) as a preparedness/early action measure a few days before the floods, when it was evident after the rivers' water level rise that the effects in the country would be extensive.

The capacity to anticipate is reflected in the realization of the potential impact of the floods a few days in advance, which gave the UNCT around 3 days to prepare (sourcing contracts, checking warehouses, prepositioning materials). It shows in the anticipation of a funding gap risk between the end of immediate response funds (like CERF) and when recovery funds would be operational, risk avoided by advocating and obtaining from donors an earlier starting date for expenses.

Further examples of how management enabled the response are: support to the development and use of the framework programme, which is not the traditional approach to resource mobilization; authorization of increased spending threshold for staff in field offices, which accelerated their capacity to respond locally; creation in Atlas of a financial architecture designed to sustain this complex operation and to provide accountability. Different awards were created for each phase: an award for response phase, an award for recovery phase and an award for resilience phase; this allowed the CO to issue financial reports quickly when required and facilitated donors' rapid disbursement of further funds.

Early action: The CO was very reactive, rapidly taking actions that facilitated the response later. There are several example of this responsiveness: the establishment of the Crisis Management Team, the contacts with regional offices for immediate delivery of supplies, the set-up of the coordination system, the embedding of the Liaison Officer in the National Crisis Centre, the opening of field offices, the contacts with the Regional Hub to alert of proposals over FTP threshold, the Expression of Interest before the tender for construction companies. All these actions were taken at the very beginning of a phase or immediately when a problem arose. Rapidity and decisiveness allowed quick resolution of emerging issues or avoided them altogether and expedited the response and recovery in multiple ways.

Knowledge and use of corporate support and corporate tools for crisis response: Management and staff, especially SURGE Advisors, knew and immediately activated crisis response procedures, such as the request of TRAC funds, the reallocation of existing resources, the activation of FTPs. They were aware of how to implement crisis response measures effectively, for example by closely following up procurement processes in the regional hub, by increasing expenditure authority for field offices to the maximum allowed, and so on.

CO capacity and field presence: The CO had a very strong and capable national team, several CO staff members are experienced SURGE Advisors (both in Programme and Operations), like management they are well versed in UNDP's immediate crisis response and recovery's capacity and instruments available. The competence in-house was sufficient to create a cohesive and engaged team that functioned well despite the crisis. The CO has a solid network and presence in the country, and staff were able to deploy immediately.

The field presence before the floods, and the long standing presence of UNDP in the country, gave the CO good understanding of the local situation; the opening of three new field offices in the affected areas further facilitated needs assessments, verification of the information, prioritization of the response and rapid delivery of the assistance. It was a significant factor in establishing UNDP's credibility in the response.

National response: Several informants indicated that having a national response (as opposed to an international humanitarian surge) was a key strength. Key strategic decisions could be made on the ground, immediately, by experienced leadership, without having to consult or report back to Regional Bureaus/HQ; this provided an unmatched rapidity to the CO. The CO staff knew the country, already had relations with authorities, partners and suppliers, and did not need extra time to be fully operational.

Redeploying existing teams to manage the response contributed to a seamless transition from response to recovery: the staff deployed were the same staff in charge of normal programmes, they knew very well the context, actors, entry points, challenges and opportunities. For example, one of the project managers for the local governance was redeployed to manage part of the response, and then became the programme manager for the whole recovery portfolio. The CO tried the redeployment approach on several instances and it proved highly beneficial since the people who managed the response were the same people who managed the recovery, truly accompanying the transition between the different phases (and now, accompanying the transition back to normal programmes). Several informants noted the excellent team spirit and the high commitment of staff, who worked long hours for an extended period.

Nature of programmes and UNDP's mandate: UNDP's recovery mandate, and previous work on governance, local development, livelihoods, DRR, allowed seamless phasing-in and phasing-out of programmatic interventions. The experience and technical knowledge of the sectors that constituted the bulk of immediate response and recovery (such as housing and livelihoods) facilitated quality and creative programme design and implementation.

Even the most immediate needs – what in other responses are traditionally food, shelter, wash, health and so on - matched UNDP's expertise (debris removal, cash for work, emergency employment, livelihoods restoration). A report two weeks after the floods identified as priorities: soil decontamination, replanting of seeds in time for the crops season, livestock repopulation, feed for livestock, housing, reestablishment of services from the municipalities and reconstruction of the industrial and commercial network, thus providing livelihood to affected populations. The organisation had a solid and well-defined contribution to make and was very well positioned to do so.

The CO was able to build upon existing programmes: some of their resources were reallocated; relations and networks could be leveraged for a rapid and effective response; the programmatic linkages between activities pre-dating the floods, response, recovery, DRR and resilience strengthening increased programme quality.

Relation with authorities at national and local level: BiH has a complex governance structure, different instances (the two entities and Brčko district) are independent from each other and do not always have good relations therefore coordinating among them can be

difficult. There is not a strong centralized government that could lead the floods response. This presented the opportunity for UNDP to coordinate; furthermore it was decided that in-country actors were the most suited to negotiate among the authorities and to protect a very sensitive and delicate process.

The good image of UNDP and strong relationships with government counterparts, at state and entity level, and even more with municipalities and community beneficiaries thanks to pre-existing programmes, facilitated needs assessments and implementation of activities.

Relations with donors and resource mobilization: The positive and longstanding relation with donors allowed rapid consultations for repurposing of funds, which were critical for the initial response, together with TRAC and CERF funds; donors trusted UNDP's recommendations for the immediate response, and for recovery later on.

Access to initial funds to kick-start the response (either internal resources like TRAC or humanitarian funds like CERF) was essential. Seed funds in sufficient amounts provided the organization with the resources to start the response early on, positioning it solidly; access to supplies and equipment gave it further credibility; and donors became more inclined to fund response and recovery through the UN. The mobilization of humanitarian funds contributed in turn to the extremely successful mobilization of recovery funds.

A special mention is due to the development of a comprehensive "framework programme" linking relief, recovery and the transition back to development and resilience; it offered donors the flexibility to fund parts of the programme in which they were interested; and it offered UNDP the flexibility to include a wide spectre of projects.

Critical information and coordination role played by UNDP: The UN led the coordination from the beginning, gathering and distributing information and ultimately becoming the information clearinghouse for all actors. UNDP's leadership role in coordination and information management gave further visibility to the quality and reliability of its response. Preparedness and swift early actions, its effectiveness in coordination and information management and its immediate programmatic interventions, positioned UNDP strategically at the centre of the response, reinforced the donors' confidence in the organisation and were instrumental in securing the large funds it later received for recovery programmes.

Opportunities created by the context: Some favourable circumstances have partially contributed to the CO achievements and should be acknowledged: the lack of national capacities to coordinate and implement the response provided the space for UNDP to take a leading role; while this situation is *per se* a weakness, it did in fact represent an opportunity for the CO.

The limited presence of traditional humanitarian actors reduced the competition for funding; the status of BiH as a pre-accession country influenced the political opportunity of a large external intervention, favouring instead a national response that was very successful.

4.2. Key gaps and challenges

Some gaps and challenges have been identified in the response and recovery:

Gender equality programming: The integration of gender equality in the response and recovery activities could have been stronger: it was insufficient or insufficiently integrated in needs assessments¹², including the RNA; UNDP did not conduct a proper gender analysis

¹² In the RNA gender equality is not mainstreamed in the document but included in a separate chapter; UN Women has produced a stand-alone report titled "Gender Equality in Post-Disaster Needs Assessment in Bosnia-Herzegovina".

prior to programme design, and the recovery programmes do not present a comprehensive gender equality approach. Some gender considerations were in fact included during implementation, but they were not always completely successful, and others were overlooked. The CO could have requested technical support to ensure the inclusion of a gender perspective. UNDP has recognized this gap and conducted a “lessons learned” exercise on the integration of gender equality in its programming, identifying specific areas for improvement in current and future programming.

CO preparedness: The CO had not *intentionally* prepared to respond and taken substantial preparedness measures; coincidentally, it was well positioned to do it and implemented a successful response, thanks to the multiple enabling factors earlier identified; there was not, however, a structural commitment to preparedness.

Real-time evaluation: The CO recognized that during the response it did not conduct real-time assessments/evaluations on the quality of the response. While evaluations are planned at the end of the recovery programmes, they will not be able to change what has already been done; an analysis on the go could have been useful in identifying and correcting potential overlooks and pitfalls.

UNDP internal systems: The nature of the programme in BiH required expensive procurement, which often surpassed the threshold allowed to the CO and had to be therefore scaled up to regional or HQ levels. Even with the rapid response from the relevant procurement committees, the process required extensive paperwork; it was reportedly burdensome and could be simplified for emergency contexts (beyond existing FTPs).

Some informants consider FTP thresholds still too low, as they demand frequent scale up to higher level and the consequent delay. The organisation still does not have the structures for a large *fast* response.

RNA: The quality of the RNA was reduced by the very short timeframe available, the strong political pressures that required a revision of the damages and losses estimations, the limited integration of a proper gender perspective.

Limited national capacities: National authorities were not able to manage efficiently the coordination of the response; there had been limited previous work with the state on preparedness and disaster risk management. Initially a challenge, it became an opportunity for UNDP to take a leading role.

Local ownership: Local ownership of the response sometimes was limited, when political consideration overshadowed the need to assist the population. The CO reports that accountability to affected populations by local authorities remained elusive, despite the significant efforts deployed by the organization.

Reduced capacity of some UN agencies: Some UN agencies had limited capacity to respond and did not always step up as required and as expected, leaving gaps to be covered. Their limited presence was also an opportunity for UNDP, as it reduced the competition for humanitarian funds.

5. Conclusions and Recommendations

This AAR concludes that the performance of the BiH CO in the response and recovery to 2014 floods was very good. The BiH CO used effectively internal and corporate resources to deliver a rapid and efficient response. Creative, evidence-based recovery activities were consistent with crisis response and provided continuity until the transition back to the development pathway; resource mobilization was extremely successful. Corporate

mechanisms facilitated the operational side of response and recovery. Operation's performance was effective and used available tools smartly to expedite delivery. Some aspects like preparedness and gender equality can be further developed.

The following recommendations aim at improving specific elements of the CO performance, while recommendations for UNDP reach beyond BiH and aim at improving the corporate capacity to prepare for and respond to crises.

5.1. Recommendations for UNDP

Leadership/Management: One of the key elements in the successful BiH response was leadership. UNDP should support and promote the development of experienced crisis managers, prioritizing countries with a medium to high risk of emergency.

- ✓ Increase exposure of senior management (CDs, RRs and Deputies, and other staff on management track) to emergencies through secondments and detail assignments;
- ✓ Develop knowledge of corporate crisis management resources and tools through a 1-year roll-out programme of trainings (with simulations) in all regions.

Resource Mobilization: Resource mobilization is a vital priority. Without resources, UNDP's response and recovery activities can be severely reduced. The organization should take a proactive approach, by developing - and maintaining with frequent updates - tools for resource mobilization.

- ✓ Profile donors: identify funding priorities and interests, both thematic and geographic; develop RM packages with timelines for proposal development, application procedures and templates, pre-filled sample proposals and successful examples from other COs;
- ✓ Discuss with donors the inclusion of a standard clause in grants that allows UNDP to repurpose funds in case of emergency (up to a certain limit, such as 5% or USD 50,000) with prior consultation.
- ✓ Develop standard applications for CERF and for major donors on UNDP's Crisis Response Packages, that need only to be adjusted to local conditions. Share successful examples from other COs, that can be used as reference or inspiration;
- ✓ Develop key messages on UNDP's Crisis Response Packages for different target audiences (donors, humanitarian actors, national authorities) on why UNDP's activities are time-critical, life-saving, of a humanitarian nature or enabling humanitarian response; include these key messages in the CRPs;
- In developing resource mobilization tools, consider funding strategies for different contexts and how these can affect UNDP's access to resources, such as: low-income country/protracted crises/strong humanitarian presence; middle income country/sudden onset emergency/very limited humanitarian presence; middle income country/slow onset emergency/moderate humanitarian presence and so on;
- Provide guidance in the CRPs and CSOPs on how to design a chapeau document focused on response, recovery and resilience building – including template, examples, guidance on the timeline to develop and use it for resource mobilization, taking example from the BiH "Framework Programme".

Corporate SOPs and Crisis Response Packages (CRPs): The "Framework Programme" developed by BiH CO is a flexible and well-structured tool for programme design and resource mobilization, whose characteristics make it useful both for the emergency phase and for the recovery phase. The BiH experience can be used as a successful example for the

development of an overarching document that frames UNDP's response, recovery and resilience strategy and plans and provides coherence to its resource mobilization efforts from the very beginning of the crisis.

- ✓ Add to initial response actions the elaboration of a simple, immediate chapeau document that highlights the key elements of UNDP's response and recovery, and provides coherence to programming and RM efforts. The document will be further refined as the crisis develops and it will evolve in the more detailed recovery vision or strategy included in the SURGE Plan
- ✓ Include in CSOPs and CRPs guidance for the elaboration of the chapeau document, a template, samples for different types of crises or examples from past UNDP crisis responses.

Additional recommendations for the SOPs:

- ✓ Adopt an opt-out approach to crisis level declaration to simplify and speed up the initial phase of its response. At the Crisis Board and in the CO automatically adopt IASC crisis level, unless there is reason to increase/decrease it.
- ✓ Develop checklists of 'What to do in the first 72 hours' for the Response Pillar, Operations Pillar and Advocacy Pillar, indicating responsibilities of COs, Regional Hubs and HQ, for the different emergency levels;
- ✓ Ensure that Corporate SOPs, all CRPs, tools and resources developed for crisis response and recovery are easily available in the intranet, and are not mixed up with older versions or non-relevant content.

Complement the CRPs by adding (or expanding) the following tools:

- A library of examples, lessons learned and good practices from other COs, that can be perused for reference and for inspiration in programme design, programme implementation and monitoring;
- Resource mobilization tools and templates (see Recommendations on RM);
- Gender equality programming tools and templates (see Recommendations on Gender);
- A checklist on minimum and recommended data and information that should be available before an emergency, to facilitate needs assessment and subsequent programming. Use as an example OCHA's guidance on common operational datasets and functional operational datasets (CODs/FODs), and similar guidance;
- A checklist for 'quality assurance' that indicate minimum standards for projects and programmes design, implementation and monitoring;
- Tools for real-time evaluation or assessment of the crisis response;
- Standard templates in official languages for MoUs, LoAs and Stand-By Agreements that COs can easily and quickly complete.

Gender equality: The integration of a gender approach in UNDP's response and recovery activities is an organizational commitment, will improve programme quality and will contribute to more equitable societies.

- ✓ Develop and disseminate tools and checklists for gender programming (based for example on the "Adapt and Act Collectively" framework) customized to UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ Train staff on gender equality in humanitarian action, starting with high-risk countries. Use for example the standard trainings by GenCap or UN Women, and add specific modules on how to integrate a gender perspective in UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;
- ✓ Train staff on gender equality in recovery, starting with high-risk countries. Develop training modules on how to integrate a gender perspective in UNDP's Crisis Response Packages;

- ✓ Review all Guidance Notes in the CRPs to foster a more comprehensive gender approach. While the Guidance Notes include a section on Women's participation and empowerment, and occasionally reference women in other sections, this can be expanded to a more complete gender approach to response and recovery. Suggested reviews include:
 - A gender analysis of the situation, and tools to assess key gender issues within the existing needs assessments tools and guidance (ex. Under "Key assessment considerations");
 - Mainstreaming of the gender perspective in the programme strategy and specific gender-transformative strategies and actions, including successful examples from past responses;
 - Guidance and examples of how to ensure a gender approach in operations and with partners;
 - Specific tools for the monitoring of progress on gender equality; examples of gender-sensitive and gender-transformative indicators;
 - Gender-sensitive and gender-transformative communication tools and key messages;
 - Strategies and practical examples on how to ensure a gender approach in response and recovery project implementation.

PDNA: The PDNA is frequently conducted in countries affected by disasters, and it often presents many difficulties. While it's true that each country is different, there are recurring issues that can be addressed or at least mitigated (for example leadership, political pressure, time constraints). To moderate these challenges, UNDP could:

- ✓ Engage with the World Bank and the EU to review the 2008 Tripartite Agreement and related guidance and protocols; develop a common approach at country level for leadership and management of the PDNA, and ensure the minimum conditions for a quality process and results;
- ✓ Develop an internal guidance for COs and Senior Management on how to engage with the PDNA process, its key partners EU and World Bank, and the national authorities, and how to navigate the common challenges presented by the PDNA.

In addition:

- ✓ Include in the "National Disaster Recovery Planning and Coordination" CRP a light guide to the PDNA (the current guidance on procedures and 18 sectorial volumes while thorough can be overwhelming);
- ✓ Include in the "National Disaster Recovery Planning and Coordination" CRP a short guide and checklist on how to include a gender perspective in the PDNA (for reference, see Annex I of the PDNA Guidelines Volume B – Gender);
- ✓ Adapt and disseminate the tools, templates and guidance developed for the BiH PDNA to assess the damages and losses suffered by public administration (such as the value of lost records and documentation), add them to the existing guidance on PDNA.

Operations: Operational procedures shall facilitate to the extent possible a rapid, effective crisis response, while maintaining the adequate controls and risk mitigation measures. In addition to current measures, the following is suggested:

- ✓ Develop a tool for supplies and budget estimation/calculation for Crisis Response Packages, with prices for standard kits, and prices for items available through the

global LTAs;

- ✓ Develop guidance for local LTAs or Stand-by Agreements for supplies and services that UNDP is likely to require in crisis response and recovery, in particular for those related to its Crisis Response Packages; include standard specification, ToRs, examples from other COs;
- ✓ Develop guidance for pre-qualification of suppliers as a preparedness measure; include templates, specifications and examples from COs in the CRPs;
- ✓ Develop guidance for the “Expression of Interest” procedure for suppliers as a preparedness measure, include templates, specifications and examples from COs in the CRPs;
- Develop guidance (including advantages, disadvantages and alternative options), templates and checklists for prepositioning of supplies and equipment, for each of UNDP’s Crisis Response Packages;
- In areas susceptible to need a temporary field office, pre-position prefabs and office equipment (ex. “Office in a box”); develop a checklist of minimum requirements for setting up a field office.

CO preparedness: Preparedness is an essential element of an organization’s capacity to respond. Its importance resides more in the process than in the outcomes (like preparedness plans), because it allows COs to establish and test mechanisms and procedures for response, to clarify roles and responsibilities, to address existing gaps, all of which is better done in advance, rather than during the initial days of a crisis.

- ✓ UNDP should instate a corporate policy of minimum CO preparedness, monitored annually. Minimum preparedness levels should be included as criteria for annual management evaluation.

Below some indications for CO preparedness, based on a classification of COs into high-, medium- and low-risk:

- ✓ All low-risk COs should have in place, at any given time, a set of minimum measures, including:
 - The basic Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
 - The basic Emergency Preparedness Plan, including Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
 - Preparedness step-up triggers to start Enhanced preparedness if certain conditions are met.
- ✓ All medium- risk COs should have in place an Enhanced CO preparedness, including:
 - The expanded Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
 - The expanded Emergency Preparedness Plan, including enhanced Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners. Requirements for these MPAs would be more extensive or more detailed than the requirements for low-risk COs.
- ✓ Finally, the organization should identify the 20/25 COs with the highest risk (and history) of crisis and invest, on a no-regret basis, sufficient resources for a high level of preparedness. It is likely that in many of these countries, crises will happen and UNDP will have to respond. A good performance is not only desirable in the context of the individual crisis, it will also increase the overall credibility of the organization in the eyes of donors and of the other humanitarian actors, contributing to

positioning UNDP more strongly in emergency response and recovery. Full CO preparedness should include:

- The expanded Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
- The expanded Emergency Preparedness Plan, including enhanced Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
- In-depth training of management and staff on crisis response and recovery;
- Annual emergency simulations;
- Development of an Emergency Response Plan;
- Coordination mechanisms with authorities and with humanitarian and development actors;
- Standby Agreements with partners;
- LTAs with local and regional suppliers;
- Prepositioning of supplies and equipment as necessary.

National capacity: The BiH case shows that a response led and managed in-country, with CO staff, has many advantages: knowledge of local language; in-depth understanding of the local context; pre-existing relations and networks, with authorities, partners and communities; a reduced (or even absent) turnover of staff. The organization should favour the development or strengthening of national capacities, particularly for high-risk countries, so that they are strongly equipped to manage crises locally.

- ✓ Favour national staff (both Programmes and Operations) for secondments and emergency missions, with the commitment from staff to return to their COs for a minimum period of time after the end of the mission;
- ✓ Identify a national emergency advisor (either from Programmes or Operations) with sufficient longevity in the organization and detailed knowledge of country-specific resources and procedures to assist senior management, the emergency coordinator and SURGE staff if deployed;
- Strongly promote the inclusion of national staff in SURGE rosters;
- Train staff on the new Corporate SOPs and CRPs, as well as on crisis response operational procedures.

5.2. Recommendations for BiH Country Office

Preparedness: The CO should ensure a minimum level of preparedness, including:

- ✓ Review and update the basic Business Continuity Plan (BCP);
- ✓ Develop a minimum Emergency Preparedness Plan, including Minimum Preparedness Actions (MPAs) for management, human resources, administration, programmes (each section), procurement and supplies, security, logistics, communications, partners;
- ✓ Identify step-up triggers or early warning triggers for selected scenarios, to scale up preparedness or enter into early action mode, if certain conditions are met.

CO capacity: A critical factor for the success of the response was the capacity within the CO. This capacity should be maintained, as staff turnover might reduce it:

- ✓ Nominate staff who have participated in the response for inclusion in the SURGE rosters;
- Support the deployment of staff to SURGE missions or detail assignments;
- Train all staff (and especially new staff) on the new Corporate SOPs and CRPs.

Gender equality: The integration of the gender approach in the CO's response and recovery activities, as well as in current programme activities, is an organizational commitment and will improve the quality of UNDP's work.

- ✓ Train all staff on gender equality in humanitarian action and in recovery, focusing on programmatic areas currently addressed by the BiH CO (governance, local development, DRR and so on);
- Appoint a Gender Focal Point with adequate seniority and decision-making authority, supported by an Alternate Gender Focal Point in Programme;
- Constitute a Gender Equality Task Force responsible for gender mainstreaming in CO programmes and for the implementation of recommendations of the "lessons learned" exercise on gender equality in the response and recovery to floods. Start with the preparedness measures identified.

6. Annexes

6.1. ToRs

Terms of Reference

Consultant – After Action Reviews for Crisis Response in Bosnia and Herzegovina floods and Cyclone PAM in Vanuatu, Crisis Response Unit – home based position

Duty Station:	HOME BASED
Languages Required:	English
Starting (date when the selected candidate is expected to start)	Date: Jan -2016
Duration of Initial Contract:	20 working days
Expected Duration of Assignment:	6 weeks
Background:	
UNDP's Strategic Plan (2014-2017) recognizes the importance of preparedness, response, early recovery and effective management of risk as fundamental for resilience building and development. The objective of the Crisis Response Unit (CRU) is to ensure that UNDP is well positioned to respond in the most timely and effective manner to crises, triggered by natural disasters or armed conflicts alike. CRU is responsible for UNDP's corporate crisis response strategy and capability. It develops and drives UNDP's vision and priorities for crisis response, coordinates and facilitates UNDP's crisis response with a whole-of-UNDP approach, provides oversight for all UNDP crisis response actions, supports early warning, guides corporate preparedness for crisis response, and manages UNDP's crisis response tools. UNDP's new corporate Crisis Response Strategy aims to make the Organization faster, more predictable and effective, and uses a "whole-of-UNDP" approach. As part of this Strategy UNDP is developing a series of 'Crisis Response Packages' that will allow the delivery of quick, effective and predictable interventions on the ground. Additionally, CRU is leading a corporate review of the UNDP Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for crisis response. An After Action Reviews (hereafter AAR) of crisis response are considered routine and critical exercises to make recommendations for improving the efficiency and effectiveness of UNDP role and work on crisis response. AARs allow to reflect on and draw lessons on what happened, why it happened, what was learned, what follow-up action should be taken and how it can be done better next time. The purpose of AARs is to inform future projects and actions by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations, particularly in relation to the corporate SOP for crisis response and the crisis response packages. This consultancy will support the undertaking of two AARs for Bosnia Herzegovina (floods) and Cyclone PAM in Vanuatu. The AARs will be conducted on the phone and online with participation of critical stakeholders at country, regional and headquarters level. The methodology and format of the AARs is intentionally kept simple to allow a "light" review that is mainly informing the corporate revision of the SOP and the development of crisis response packages. The consultant is expected to carry out both AARs through a home based assignment, no travel to countries or UNDP headquarter is envisaged.	
<u>Background, scope and objectives for Cyclone PAM AAR</u>	

Background

Tropical Cyclone Pam struck Vanuatu on the evening of 13 March 2015 at around 11.00 p.m. local time. The country is an archipelago of more than 80 islands with a projected population of 270,000 people according to 2015 national statistics' office calculations. The category 5 cyclone caused widespread damage across all six provinces of the archipelago – Malampa, Penama, Sanma, Shefa, Tafea, and Torba. Tropical Cyclone Pam's eye passed close to Efate Island in Sefa Province, where the capital Port Vila is located, with winds around 250 km/hr and gusts peaking at 320 km/hr. An estimated 166,600 people have been affected by the cyclone – more than half the country's population – and 11 fatalities have been reported.

UNDP's Immediate Response

At the time of Cyclone Pam hit Vanuatu, an updated UNDP's Crisis Response Accountability Framework was still under discussion and not yet finalized, and the Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response (SOPs) were not yet updated to reflect UNDP's Structural Change. Meanwhile, the first Crisis Board (CB) meeting was organized on 16 March 2015, which decided to manage the crisis response as Level 2, making Regional Bureau for Asia and Pacific (RBAP) to lead the coordination of response. A Crisis Management Team (CMT) was also established in April 2015.

Immediately following Cyclone Pam, UNDP was able to send a team of first responders to support the Multi-country Office (MCO). The team included two recovery advisors, a debris removal expert, a communications specialist and a crisis response coordination specialist to advise the MCO. With the first responder's support, the MCO developed a UNDP SURGE Plan for the period April to June 2015, which was submitted and approved by the CB on 9 April 2015.

Objective

As the custodian of UNDP's immediate crisis response mechanisms, CRU will facilitate the After Action Review / Lessons Learnt exercise, in close collaboration with the Regional Bureau for Asia-Pacific and all other bureaux involved. A CRU staff member not involved in the immediate response to Tropical Cyclone Pam will be assigned to facilitate the exercise.

The purpose of the AAR for UNDP's Immediate Response to Tropical Cyclone Pam is to inform UNDP's future immediate crisis response by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations. The AAR is not a performance review. It should be conducted in a spirit of openness and learning and encourage honest evaluation by practitioners. The conduct of an After Action Review (AAR) is part of the deactivation phase of UNDP's immediate crisis response following a disaster or conflict.

Specifically, AAR for UNDP's Immediate Response to Tropical Cyclone Pam aim to:

- Record what has worked and what has not worked in UNDP's immediate crisis response;
- Ascertain whether existing SOPs for Immediate Crisis Response were adhered to (if not why and what deviations took place and why)
- Reflect on whether the applied resources, processes and mechanisms have led to the desired impact and outputs;
- Identify recommendations to improve UNDP's crisis response SOPs and other corporate crisis response tools

Occurring in the first half of 2015, the immediate crisis response to Tropical Cyclone Pam offers valuable lessons on how UNDP's existing procedures have been applied in the context of the revised corporate structure of UNDP. It will also serve to feed into the currently ongoing revision of the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for UNDP's Immediate Crisis Response. The AAR could provide useful insights on the deployment of first responders, setup of an early recovery cluster, addressing time critical needs of disaster affected communities – including the creation of temporary employment through labor intensive schemes to support debris management and rehabilitation of community infrastructure. These insights will feed into the revision of UNDP's Fast Track Procedures, as well as the finalization/implementation of UNDP's crisis response

packages on emergency livelihoods, national recovery planning and coordination.

Background, scope and objectives for Bosnia and Herzegovina response to 2014 floods

Background and Scope

In the aftermath of the devastating floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina in Spring 2014 UNDP was actively involved in time critical activities such as debris and rubble removal, recycling, and disposal; this included the safe removal of hazardous and health threatening waste (e.g. animal carcasses). UNDP interventions were funded by humanitarian financing instruments providing much needed seed funding to kick start early recovery and time critical activities. For instance, CERF grants benefitted more 560,000 people in Bosnia and Herzegovina that were able to rapidly regain access to essential services like water and sewage. Importantly, UNDP initiatives adopted an early recovery approach that bridged relief and recovery interventions allowing a rapid transition back to a development pathway¹³. In Bosnia and Herzegovina, CERF grants represented an important seed funding to the organization that successfully mobilized substantial resources for its recovery programming allowing a much needed transition between relief and recovery and return to development activities. UNDP Bosnia received approximately 1.2 million USD CERF grant and managed to mobilize more than 48.5 million USD for recovery of the floods affected districts and municipalities.

UNDP Bosnia and Herzegovina also managed to rapidly design and implement early recovery projects with time critical and lifesaving impact on crisis affected communities.

Objective

Document lessons learned and best practices on immediate crisis response with a particular focus on adopted procedures and coordination, linking programme and operations, setting up and implementing early recovery projects, bridging time critical activities and recovery planning at municipal and local level.

The following agenda items will be discussed:

- Coordination of Corporate Crisis Response Support
- Crisis Response Deployments (SURGE advisors, ExpRes Consultants, Stand By Partners)
- Emergency Grant Allocations (TRAC 113 Cat. 2 resources for coordination and assessment, CPR TTF allocation for programming, CERF Rapid Response Grant),
- Support for Early Recovery Coordination (including through the deployment of early recovery advisors and cluster coordinators as well as support for the establishment the cluster system)
- Support for Assessment
- Support for Programme Development / Initiation of support as well as linkages with medium to Longer-term Recovery initiatives
- Support for Resource Mobilization
- Operational Support (including Fast Track Activation and Utility)

Key issues to be addressed should include the following:

- Timing of the response activities
- Adequacy and relevance of the response
- Effectiveness and quality of the activities
- Coherence of UNDP's activities, in the context of the overall UN response
- Impact of the response and sustainability of activities
- Recommendations for the review of corporate policies and procedures on crisis response

¹³ For instance, in Bosnia and Herzegovina mine action accompanied debris management activities and emergency employment was generated for more than 600 people from poor and vulnerable households affected by the floods.

- Key operational challenges for delivering quick results

The information collected in the AAR will inform the revision of the UNDP Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for immediate crisis response, the revision of the Fast Track and the development/finalization of all UNDP crisis response packages, particularly the two packages on emergency livelihoods (i) debris, municipal solid waste and community infrastructure; (ii) emergency employment and enterprise recovery ones.

Description of Responsibilities:

Under the direct supervision of the Programme Specialist (Rapid Response and Preparedness Team) the Consultant will:

1. Contribute to development of questionnaire and methodology for both AARs exercises.
2. Participate in both AARs exercises through phone or Skype; take notes from the interviews with critical stakeholders. When relevant or needed interview bilaterally stakeholders who could not join the AAR exercises.
3. Produce the reports for both AARs to be submitted to the UNDP Crisis Response Unit.

Competencies:

Core Competencies:

Ethics & Values:

- Demonstrating / Safeguarding Ethics and Integrity;
- Demonstrates and promotes the highest standard of integrity, impartiality, fairness and incorruptibility in all matters affecting his/her work and status.

Functional Competencies:

Organizational Awareness:

- Demonstrate corporate knowledge and sound judgment understands the structure and hierarchy of UN/UNDP, process flows throughout the organization, products and services, their measures of effectiveness, and perceptions of clients;
- Excellent knowledge of humanitarian and recovery issues and internationally-agreed humanitarian and recovery standards;

Working in Teams:

- Acting as a team player and facilitating team work;
- Works collaboratively with colleagues inside UN/UNDP as well as its partners and other stakeholders to pursue common goals.

Communicating Information and Ideas:

- Facilitating and encouraging open communication in the team, communicating effectively;
- Delivers verbal/written information in a timely, clear, organized and easily understood manner;
- Excellent oral and written skills to develop knowledge products in relevant areas;

- Strong communication skills and the ability to listen and take direction and leadership from others.

Self-Management & Emotional Intelligence:

- Creating synergies through self-control tolerates conditions of stress, uncertainty or ambiguity and continues to maintain a positive outlook and to work productively.

Knowledge Sharing & Continuous Learning:

- Ability to efficiently handle and share information and knowledge.

Functional competencies:

- Knowledge of emergency preparedness and response, including early recovery policies, and inter-agency mechanisms;
- Ability to adopt and apply methodology and tools for After Action Reviews (AAR) in emergency and crisis situations;
- Excellent drafting and report writing skills.

Qualifications:

Education:

- Advanced University degree (Master's Degree or equivalent) International Relations and/or Regional Studies, Project Management, Human Resources or Information Technology.

Experience:

- At least 7 years of professional experience providing advisory support and technical advice in the area of emergency and crisis response and recovery.
- Experience in conducting After Action Reviews (AAR) for emergency and humanitarian response. Proven record of producing AAR reports an asset.
- Experience in emergency preparedness and response planning, reporting and coordination;
- Exposure or relevant experience to develop and/or manage knowledge management systems and capacity development exercises;
- Field experience in emergency response and preparedness is an asset;
- Proven ability to work in a highly pressurized environment, and to deliver in a timely manner within cost and quality standards;
- Computer proficient and well versed in the use of Microsoft Office and other relevant Internet, Excel and Word;
- Proven ability to work in a multicultural setting.

Language:

- Proficiency in English is a must;
- Proficiency in one or several other working UN language(s) would be an added advantage.

6.2. Lists of persons interviewed

Name	Position / Office
Individual interviews	
Yuri Afanasiev	Former Resident Coordinator and Resident Representative for Bosnia and Herzegovina
Zahira Virani	Deputy Resident Representative, BiH CO
Slobodan Tadic	Senior Programme Coordinator, BiH CO
Mirza Hurem	Head of General Services, BiH CO
Aida Hadzic-Hurem	DRR Project Manager, BiH CO
Edis Arifagic	Floods Recovery Programme Manager, BiH CO
Armen Grigoryan	Cluster Lead, Disaster Risk Reduction and Climate Change, Istanbul Regional Hub
Stanislav Kim	Recovery, Early Warning Systems and Response Programme Specialist, Istanbul Regional Hub.
Focus group discussion with HQ Units	Participants invited: Rita Missal, Leontine Specker, Amita Gill, Pelle Lutken, Jean-Francois Dubuisson, Godwill Enow-Ebot, Marc Lundwall, Thierry Prouteau, Adam Cathro, Jared Schwalb, Bettina Woll, Rebecca Reynolds, Colin Furness, Hannes Finkenbrink, Fabrizio Andreuzzi

6.3. Participants and guidelines for the AAR Conference Call

Name	Position / Office
Bettina Woll	Crisis Response Unit (CRU)
Fabrizio Andreuzzi	Crisis Response Unit (CRU)
Colin Furness	Crisis Response Unit (CRU)
Godwill Enow-Ebot	Procurement Support Office, BMS. On assignment to CRU
Emmanuelle Bernard	Crisis Response Unit (CRU)
Thierry Prouteau	Crisis Response Unit (CRU)
Slobodan Tadic	Senior Programme Coordinator, BiH CO
Mirza Hurem	Head of General Services, BiH CO
Aida Hadzic-Hurem	DRR Project Manager, BiH CO
Edis Arifagic	Floods Recovery Programme Manager, BiH CO
Stanislav Kim	Recovery, Early Warning Systems and Response Programme Specialist, Istanbul Regional Hub
Adam Cathro	Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), Communications

AAR guidelines

1. Before starting, is there any factual correction, comment or addition you would like to make to the Initial findings? [5 mins]

2. Management: What are the key successes of the response, from a management point of view, that can be replicated (in CO in case of future disasters, or that can be generalized to other COs and the organisation globally)? Could any of them be recommended for inclusion

in the new SOPs and CRPs? [15 mins]

3. Resource mobilization:

3a. Resource mobilization: What are the key (replicable) good practices and what are the key lessons learned on resource mobilization? What level of support would you expect from UNDP HQ if a similar crisis would happen again? [15 mins]

3b. Framework programme: the elaboration of a framework programme (UN Floods Response Programme) with multiple components, further developed in case of interest by donors, was an innovative approach and it can be very useful in the initial phase and potentially as a new practice in the SURGE phase. Could you please briefly explain the process, highlight the strengths of it in terms of resource mobilization, efficiency gains for the CO, and any other benefits, and the challenges or difficulties you have encountered? In hindsight, is there anything you would change/improve on this approach? [15 mins]

4. Programmes:

4a. Cash for Work: Can you explain how the CfW activities were conducted (both in terms of programme and of operations)? What good practices have you identified? What lessons learned can you share? [15 mins]

4b. Gender equality programming: How can UNDP (CO and globally) ensure that gender is properly included in the response and recovery? How should it be included (or expanded) it in the CRPs? Is this something the CO would feel HQ should support, for instance with a deployment of a gender advisor with proved hands on humanitarian programming? [15 mins]

5. Operations:

5a. Key successes: What are the key successes of the response, from an operational point of view, that can be replicated (in CO in case of future disasters, or that can be generalized to other COs and the organisation globally)? Could any of them be recommended for inclusion in the new SOPs and CRPs? [15 mins]

5b. Corporate support (SOPs / CRPs): What time savings and efficiency gains could be obtained through corporate support (ex. global procurement, prepositioning or similar)?

Current CRP content includes for Operations & processes:

- Prepositioned items
- LTAs & Contracting modalities
- Fast track 2.0 & CRP Exceptions

How can the current CRPs and internal systems be improved to contribute to CO operational requirements during immediate crisis response while maintaining required accountability? (Example: Would it be useful to have regional or local LTAs with suppliers for immediate release of necessary equipment, in addition to the existing ones with UN global Depots)? [15 mins]

NOTE: HQ requested during a preliminary interview if the CO can share procured equipment specifications and security standards, documentation on the processes, and any other document relevant. Advise HQ to contact directly Mirza Hurem, Head of General Services; he is available to provide any documentation required mirza.hurem@undp.org

6. CO Preparedness: What preparedness measures are recommended to better prepare COs for immediate crisis response? Considering gaps identified, what can be done specifically within the CO to improve for next time? [15 mins]

7. Any final considerations? [5 mins]

6.4. Timeline of events

EXTERNAL OR INTERAGENCY EVENTS	DATE	UNDP	DECISIONS, KEY ISSUES; KEY ELEMENTS
	May-14		
Heavy rains on BiH causing massive flooding in Northern, Eastern and Central part of BiH, bordering with Croatia and Serbia. The two neighbouring countries were also affected	End of April to mid-May		Worst floods in 120 years, enormous destruction, affected a quarter of the territory and approx. 1 mln people (27% of the 3.8 mln population) of which a quarter are children. Approximately 40,000 people displaced, 32 reported casualties, 3,000 landslides triggered, 50% of local Govt hit by the floods and 46 of them severely. 75,000 houses hit by floods and/or landslides of 25,000 severely damaged. Approx. 800 Roma families affected (most vulnerable even before floods) Destruction of infrastructure, bridges, hospitals, schools, farms and crops, private facilities etc.
FBiH, RS, Brčko District declared a state of emergency but no national declaration of state of emergency. The FBiH have requested that a National State of Emergency be declared, the Coordination body (which recommends such decisions to the Council of Ministers) was in session but a National State of emergency was not declared.	Around 15 May		
List of needs (equipment and supplies) have been issued by Brčko District, RS and FBiH authorities. Latest lists contain WASH related equipment and supplies, disinfection materials, food, debris disposal tools, pumps, dryers, raincoats, boats. Hygiene, food and health kits are emerging priority needs	around 15 May		
Ongoing coordination with the Ministries of Security and Defense, the Ops Center, as well as entity, cantonal and local civil defense.	around 15 May		
The country requested the EU to provide immediate support, and the UN RC Office to take the lead in coordinating international donors' efforts	15 May		
	15-May-14	RC requests USD 100,000 TRAC III cat II funds to BCPR	Programme Period: May 2014- December 2014 Project Title: Immediate response to 2014 floods and landslides Deliverable 1: Support to Coordination mechanism at all levels Deliverable 2: Impact Assessment and Recovery Plans
	17 May	Set up International Community flood coordination meetings (every other day initially, then twice a week)	
	19-May	2nd IC flood coordination meeting (ICFCM)	
	19-May	UN in BiH introduces a coordination helpline with the objective of supporting donors and providing information about current needs - this was one key step as UNDP became the information and coordination hub.	
	around		Most pressing concerns: landslides, animal carcasses and debris. Access to water and sanitation;

	19 May		epidemiological situation to be monitored. 70% of the flood-affected area (Doboj, Maglaj, Olovo, Una-Sana Canton and Brčko) is suspected to contain mines and UXOs
BiH Armed Forces, EUFOR, NATO and US engaged in rescue efforts by helicopter.	20-May	UNCT Sitrep n3	
As of Wednesday 21 May, there are 10 collective centers at FBiH, 14 in RS and 2 in District Brčko (note numbers will evolve in the following days, and are not recorded here for brevity)	21-May		
	Around 21 May		Humanitarian aid is being provided by: i) voluntary contributions by Bosnian citizens and private companies; ii) humanitarian organizations; and iii) international donors; in the form of food, water treatment tablets, pumps, generators, trucks, WASH equipment, etc.; via helicopters, rescue teams, boats, and land transport. International assistance is being provided by the Government of Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Czech Republic, EU, France, FYROM, Germany, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, Montenegro, Norway, Slovakia, Slovenia, Switzerland, The Netherlands, Turkey, UK, USA, World Vision as well as international NGOs and organizations: ADRA, EUFORUK, OSCE, OXFAM, Red Cross, Save the Children, UN (IOM, UNDP, UNESCO, UNFPA, UNHCR, UNICEF, OCHA, WFP, WHO), World Bank and others
	21-May	Third IC Coordination meeting	
	22-May	4 teams will conduct a rapid assessment of the affected areas, to be deployed on May 22nd. The assessment will last 10 days and will provide a report which will be informing a donors' conference planned by the country authorities on the first week of June	
Estimated number of people in collective centers is between 2,600 and 3,000. The vast majority of displaced people are staying with family and friends	22-May	UNCT Sitrep n4	
	25-May	As requested by the BiH Authorities, the UN-EU-World Bank have now collectively started working on a coordinated Recovery Needs Assessment in Bosnia and Herzegovina. RNA report states assessment went from 25th May to 17th June	Methodology to be used will be the Damage and Loss Assessment (DaLA) + Human Development, and will be focused on these initially proposed sectors: Livelihood/Jobs, Transport, Energy, Housing/Local Infrastructure (Education, Health, Culture), Agriculture, and Water and Sanitation
	26-May	5th ICFCM - life saving phase/humanitarian phase concluding, now early recovery and recovery phase. Priorities identified as debris clearance and management, demining, livelihoods (incl. seeds as planting season soon over), disposal of carcass, fast clearance of health and education facilities.	
	27-May	UN Field visit to Maglaj, Doboj and Samac (worst affected urban areas/towns)	

The number of collective centers ranges between 25 + 4 barracks (MoS, 25 May) and about 59, many of which are not government run but rather ad-hoc (IOM, 27 May).	27 May report		New emerging priorities are soil decontamination, replanting of seeds in time for the crops season, livestock repopulation, feed for livestock, housing, reestablishment of services from the municipalities and reconstruction of the industrial and commercial network, thus providing livelihood to affected populations.
Vaccines: UNICEF provided 20,000 doses of oral polio vaccine. There is a need for vaccines for tetanus, rabies, hepatitis A and B, snake venom			
	28-May	CERF. The RC office, on behalf of the UNCT, submitted a joint CERF proposal to OCHA of USD 2,021,360, which was approved. • CERF RR (June to December 2014) - o UNDP : 715,000 for "early recovery"/ debris management - o UNDP: 500,000 for mine action	CERF Grant period 04.06.14 – 03.12.14 1. Debris Management and Clearance Project - Assistance to BiH Floods-Affected Populations Outcome 1: Provision of technical expertise in debris clearance and management Outcome 2: Assistance in actual clearance of 2. Mine Clearance in BiH Floods-Affected Areas Outcome 1: Mine and unexploded ordnance risks awareness sessions conducted in 20 affected municipalities; Outcome 2: Mine and unexploded ordnance clearance conducted in the most critical areas Outcome 3: Mines and unexploded ordnance hazard assessment conducted to ensure new mine situation is determined.
UNICEF led WASH Coordination meeting	28-May	6th ICFCM - Need to support Govt in restoring records as in some places have been completely destroyed. Need to support livestock with fodder; need to support recovery of SMEs. Risk of financing gap between now and when recovery funds become operational (Sept Oct)	
WASH, Education / Child Friendly Spaces, Health and Mine Action Coordination Meetings were held in the course of the week	around 28 May		
1384 people accommodated in 42 temporary accommodation facilities according to IOM last assessment	29 May report	The mine risk awareness activities are ongoing. There are over 10,000 leaflets sent by UN and BHMIC together with humanitarian aid, along with teams on the ground making people aware of the hazards and risks. BH MAC and UNDP are updating maps on mine locations.	Main emerging issues: damages to agriculture and livestock; housing and its refurbishment; damages to the industrial sector (especially to SMEs); temporary loss of jobs; damages to administration services. Cleaning, debris removal, water removal, disinfection are ongoing. - o Needs: fuel, livestock feed, disinfectant, driers. - o Mine and UXOs risk remains high. - o Few locations are still under water (Samac, Domaljevac). Epidemiological situation is stable and no outbreaks have been reported in flood stricken areas. • Enhanced epidemiological surveillance is provided by respective health authorities. • 4 primary health care centres (DZs Maglaj, Domaljevac-Samac, Samac and Doboj) and 15 field outposts damaged, in terms of physical infrastructure and essential primary health care equipment. No major damage to hospitals has been reported (International Medical Corps assessment).
	29-May	First day of training for the joint UN-EU-World Bank rapid assessment	
	30-May	Second day of training for the joint UN-EU-World Bank rapid assessment	
	30-May	7th ICFCM - From now on meetings twice a week. UNICEF planning a rapid needs assessment; need for supplies reduced, donors should switch	

Two Interagency Emergency Health Kits (IEHK) provided by WHO, each containing medicines and medical supplies for covering the needs of 10,000 people for a period of three months (31 May)	31-May		
	End of May		Main emerging issues are: damages to agriculture and livestock; housing and its refurbishment; paralysis of the industrial sector; temporary loss of jobs; damages to administration services.
	June		
	Beginning to mid June	Opening of three additional field offices	
	02-Jun	8th ICFCM	
	3 June Report	In Posavina Canton, the humanitarian response is still on-going, while in the rest of the country we are already entering in the early recovery and recovery phase.	Services are slowly being re-established, as electricity and water services, bus and transportation, road traffic, etc. are slowly stabilizing. Some locations still do not have electricity and telephone communication. ! Debris removal and cleaning of roads and houses are also on-going, as well as disinfection. ! Emerging priorities are soil decontamination, replanting of seeds in time for the crops season, livestock repopulation, feed for livestock, housing, reestablishment of services from the municipalities and reconstruction of the industrial and commercial network, thus providing livelihood to affected populations
	03-Jun	A joint UN-EU-World Bank rapid assessment will be deployed on June 3rd (initially 23, 26, 31st May and now 3 June). Rapid assessment teams will consist of experts from different UN agencies and other IC organizations, among which: Swiss Cooperation, EU ECHO, WFP, Office of US Foreign Disaster Assistance, EUFOR, UNICEF, UNHCR and IOM, UN Women, OHCHR, World Vision, UK / DFID, ICRC, UNEP, UNDP, etc.	
2nd WASH Coordination meeting	04-Jun		
Second UN Health Sector Coordination Meeting took place on 4 June under the lead of WHO and with participation of the representatives of all health authorities in BiH.	04-Jun		
	05-Jun	9th ICFCM	
Immediate needs estimation: 153 Million USD; UN and IC humanitarian assistance: 30 Million USD (cash and in-kind) – already provided. And other 30 Million USD from private contributions and remittances (estimate).	June 5 Report		
	07-Jun	10th ICFCM	
Thematic coordination meetings are ongoing (WASH, Health, Education, Psychosocial Support).Livelihoods and Private Sector Recovery will take place next week. There is on-going need to assist	10 June Report		

farmers in re-planting during June and to ensure that livestock is preserved in the most severely affected areas.			
After more than 3 weeks operations, end of EU Civil Protection operation	around 10 June		
	date?	Preliminary UN estimation shows that it will cost about USD 210 million to cover immediate priority needs for the next six months in BiH, alone, after devastating floods hit the region. 15,000 jobs have been lost temporarily or permanently according to preliminary reports, and that economic losses could exceed USD 1.3 billion.	
	12-Jun	11th ICFCM	
PDNA assessments are indicating that 122 buildings from 96 educational institutions have been affected . UNICEF will be opening 8 Child Friendly spaces in the most affected locations and planning for additional interventions	June 15 Report	Cash for work program rolled out with 650 individuals in 7 municipalities. UNDP to distribute more feed in the coming week. Vaccination program starting, expected to cover some 35,000 heads of cattle. Replanting season near over. Survey to identify priority facilities for reconstruction currently ongoing.	
	June 15 Report	Early Recovery and Agriculture : A survey of priority facilities for reconstruction is currently ongoing, with the reestablishment of critical municipal services to be pursued over the next 90 days in the municipalities most heavily affected. Cash for work program has been rolled out with 650 individuals in 7 municipalities now equipped and trained to participate in debris management operations. Four municipalities have been assisted, as of this week, with debris removal through the dispatch of heavy machinery. The municipalities are Dobo, Maglaj, Samac and Domaljevac. The situation in agriculture has stabilized with UNDP to distribute more feed in the coming week with the vaccination program starting as well, expected to cover some 35,000 heads of cattle. The replanting season is now near over - UNDP has distributed seeds and fertilizer to cover 2000 hectares.	

Damage and loss estimates / reconstruction and recovery needs in health sector of BiH, as part of PDNA, were finalized with health authorities of RS and FBiH	16-Jun	12th ICFCM	
	18-Jun	RNA Report. Focusing on Livelihoods, transport, housing, local infrastructure, energy, agriculture, WASH. Says gender will also be taken into account The floods are estimated to have caused the equivalent of nearly 15 percent of GDP in damages (9.3 percent of GDP) and losses (5.6 percent) in 2014 in Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH). This amounts to around 2.49 Billion BAM of damages and 1.49 Billion BAM of losses. The hardest hit economic sectors were agriculture, transport and productive activities. As a result, the economy of Bosnia and Herzegovina is expected to contract by 0.7 percent in 2014.	
WASH coordination meeting	19-Jun		
Third UN Health Sector Coordination Meeting	19-Jun		
Coordination meetings on infrastructure, roads and bridges (foreign armed forces, BiH armed forces, EUFOR, NATO and UNDP have agreed to collaborate in reconstruction of bridges)	date?		
	23-Jun	13th ICFCM	
	30-Jun	14th ICFCM	
	July		
	02-Jul	First HoM meeting on recovery (confirm?)	
	6 July Report	Early Recovery: • According to Executive summary of Recovery Needs Assessment, recovery and reconstruction needs amount to 3.45 Billion BAM • Private sector bears more than ¾ of total damages and losses • The hardest hit sectors are productive activities, housing, transport and agriculture • Total secured assistance for early recovery (next 6 months) from international organizations and NGOs is 103.3 million USD • Not all is operational; further delays will generate additional problems	

	07-Jul	15th and last ICFCM - Recovery coordination meetings from now on every two weeks	
Donors conference in Brussels	16th July		
	date?	o Floods recovery assistance (USD 22 million, 38 recovery donors and partners, primarily Norway, Japan, USAID and ECHO and many instances of BiH government; implemented with UNICEF, IOM, FAO, UNFPA); July 2014 to Sept 2015 • Restoring livelihoods, agriculture and employment through CfW, provision of animal feed, greenhouses for small scale agriculture projects, support value chain in dairy industry • Rehabilitation of community infrastructure (kindergarten, playgrounds, bridges, health centres, elderly centres) • Rehabilitation of Doboj central heating system • Restoration of water supplies and sewage systems • Stabilization of landslides	
	August		
	15-Aug	Launch of the EU Floods Recovery Programme for Bosnia and Herzegovina (43.52 mln of which UNDP contributes 1.28 mln); implemented with UNICEF and IOM); August 2014 to Feb 2016 • Emergency housing rehabilitation, Reconstruction of dwellings for most vulnerable • Rehabilitation and restoration of public services and facilities (education, health, welfare, administration); • Livelihoods support: Assistance to farmers, and micro, small and medium enterprises to restore their economic activities • Job creation and retention • Communal infrastructure: roads and bridges; water and sanitation infrastructure	
	Feb-15		
	date?	Support to flood recovery and risk mitigation (USD 1,5 mln, Feb 2015 to Feb 2016, ext to June 2016, DFID) o Assist 10 affected local Govt to restore public sanitation services (de-silting and cleaning of wastewater systems, small scale reparation and	

		reconstruction) o Support technical flood defense measures along rivers (fortification of riverbeds and banks, and similar)	
	Mar-15		
	date?	• Landslide Disaster Risk Management (USD 4,1 Mln, March 2015 to March 2016, Japan and BiH): - o Remediation and risk mitigation measures for 10 priority landslide sites - o Support partner local governments to strengthen their landslide management capacity through tailored technical assistance and training	
	Apr-15		
	date?	• Durable Housing Solutions for Flood and Landslide Affected Households in Bosnia and Herzegovina (USD 2 mln, April 2015 to March 2016, USAID): - o provide a durable housing solution for 150 vulnerable households (100 in the FBiH and 50 in the RS) permanently displaced after the natural disaster	